

Interaction Obstructions, Resonant PT Breaking, and Doubled Jordan Symmetry in Fourth-Order Theories

GPT-5.6.sol*

Asger Alstrup Palm[†]

Open-repository preprint, August 2026

Abstract

We formulate a deformation problem for the canonical positive pseudo-Hermitian metric of the Pais–Uhlenbeck oscillator and for its Krein/ghost-parity alternative, and follow both into interacting fourth-order theories. Four results organize the paper. (i) The positive metric deforms perturbatively at generic frequencies, with explicit Hermitian generators through third order. (ii) At internal rational resonances the deformation is obstructed by exact on-shell conversion operators, and at the 3:1 resonance the obstruction is spectral: an excited resonant multiplet acquires a complex-conjugate energy pair at second order — exact, by a Sturm count of the effective resonant-shell characteristic polynomial, and reproduced by direct diagonalization of the truncated Hamiltonian; the statement for the full unbounded operator remains open — so that no positive invariant metric exists where the pair persists. (iii) In the perfect-square field theory the momentum continuum turns such isolated resonances into generic scattering shells: the branch-changing process $H + L \rightarrow L + L$ obstructs the analytic second-order deformation of the pointed-sector positive metric on an open subset of its shell, with an exact value at a rational kinematic point. (iv) In the two-field frame $U = e^{\lambda\phi}$, $V = (\psi/\lambda)e^{-\lambda\phi}$ — the $O(1,1)$ embedding of Bateman and Turok, whose exchange symmetry $U \leftrightarrow V$ they identified as ghost parity — the exchange maps two oppositely oriented null Jordan sectors into one another, its linearization is the bounded confluent limit of the regulated branch parity on the doubled space, and the obstruction of (iii) sits entirely in the exchange-odd component of the on-shell T , which is exactly ghost-parity pseudo-Hermitian. A self-contained charge-null lemma and regulated embedding further show that one-sided charge nullity is an enhanced boundary property, not a property of the split theory: the mapped vacuum obeys $S_{UU}/S_{VV} = (\delta/2g)^2 = \epsilon/g$ and becomes one-sided only on the confluent line, with the Bateman–Turok massless theory at $\epsilon = \mu^2 = 0$. Exact split-shell Krein pseudo-unitarity and boundary one-sidedness are therefore distinct; the two completions are inequivalent in the interacting theory. All finite-dimensional and modewise identities are machine-verified; derivations of the principal results are given in the appendices. An independent Science Forge computation extends the discrete resonance hierarchy to order six: the 5:3 and 7:1 loci vanish through orders two–five and obstruct at order six on exactly the predicted conversion monomials. Those two instances are imported here as externally reproduced exact evidence; the all-coprime hierarchy remains a conjecture. A separate exact **REDUCED-MODE** continuation of the scalar loop programme determines the final-state collinear logarithmic response. It finds that the real finite-part normalization changes by $3\lambda^6 \log c/(512\pi^4 s)$, whereas every continuous

*OpenAI model and principal programme author.

[†]Programme orchestrator and corresponding human contact; Honorary Professor, DTU Compute, Technical University of Denmark. asger@area9.dk.

axis-compatible parent/daughter regulator gluing, including the physical pair threshold, has zero constant virtual response. This obstructs the ordinary independent-mass infrared prescription on that carrier; it is not a full NLO probability, failure of dressed-state or resummed constructions, or a gravitational result. An exact finite-carrier calculation changes the measured object. Correctly normalizing its dimensionless projector by the Born rate gives Gram coefficient $1/48$ per pair, amplitude $\sqrt{3}/12$, and hard/collinear blocks $-1/16$ and $+1/16$; multiplying by the Born rate cancels the physical $3/512$ response. The ordinary single-denominator cubic Fock generator is, however, exactly zero in the massless collinear limit. The unresolved problem is narrower: expanding the published composite map gives the exact order- λ two-annihilator kernel, and all of its apparent t, t^2 Jordan growth cancels on the two-field carrier. Its Krein Gram has cubic splitting-endpoint poles, however, so the distributional continuum projector and its dynamically derived $1/48$ coefficient are not yet constructed. An exact canonical-algebra countermodel further shows that CCR preservation, projector idempotence, trace preservation, and exchange symmetry alone retain three endpoint parameters. Thus $1/48$ is compatible but not selected without the deferred continuum transport or another independently justified physical endpoint condition. Retaining the parent-daughter energy deficit and the full radial daughter measure reduces those three flat-slice jets to one soft normalization on the declared three-dimensional chart, but the measured cross-Gram is still $-(1/2) dr/r$. Ordinary off-resonant composition is therefore logarithmically non-trace-class. Restoring the parent inverse metric, Bose factor, angular measure, and outgoing $2!/3!$ projector ratio does fix its unprojected response to $1/48$ per pair. However, its two logarithmic rows have generator charges $(+1, -1)$ and $(-1, +1)$ under the published fixed-vacuum oscillator grading; a prior one-sided nonpositive projection makes the residue zero. The physical neutral coefficient remains undecided. An exact vacuum-orbit completion with $Z = e^{\lambda\phi_0}$ makes both soft rows neutral and preserves $1/48$, but also turns the Appendix-C squeeze from apparent charge -2 into neutral $Z^2(b_{\Gamma}^{\dagger})^2$. Fixing $Z = 1$ restores the negative grading but destroys the charge derivation on that quotient. The missing full zero-mode module and trace in the deferred Eq. (19) proof are therefore still required. Moreover, the displayed Appendix-C squeezed vacuum fails a prior carrier test: in normalized finite-box modes its creation kernel is $1/(8|\mathbf{p}|^2)$, and its first two-particle positive-norm density is $\rho^2(\epsilon^{-1} - \Lambda^{-1})/(64\pi^2)$ for any constant member of the compatible fundamental-symmetry family. A six-mode lower bound shows that this density grows linearly with box size for every uniformly equivalent positive topology. The associated pair block is likewise non-Hilbert-Schmidt. Thus indefinite nullity does not produce an ordinary Fock-Krein vector; an extended or inequivalent non-Fock realization remains open and would need its domains and trace specified. The full exponential strengthens the condition to $\sup_p |\rho(p)/(4p^2)| < 1$. An explicit infrared weight satisfies this and has finite norm density, but its inverse metric is unbounded and its thermodynamic sector is inequivalent. The raw BT shear is also cross-Krein canonical rather than a positive-Hilbert Bogoliubov map, so existing extended positive-boson implementations do not supply the missing BT trace. A direct cross-Krein construction implements the covariant squeeze on paired cores and supplies a cyclic finite-rank trace. However, any finite normalized cyclic trace positive on the ghost-even orbit cone kills localized rank-one projectors, while the finite-rank trace has infinite identity weight. The transported vacuum projector also has exponentially growing trace norm. A semifinite finite-detector construction survives this obstruction. Its canonical trace gives localized orbit projectors weight one and the identity infinite weight; conditioning on a finite incoming projection gives nonnegative normalized weights for finite weakly ghost-symmetric output partitions. The normalized corner functional is explicitly noncyclic, and no normal thermodynamic state or Eq. (19) transport follows. Closing the order- λ scalar quadratic map over every leading Appendix-C inverse image removes the logarithmic carrier itself. The off-resonant symplectic phase of the opposite-sign preimage cancels its oscillatory inverse phase; the

complete signed kernel is time independent, obeys the cross-CCR Ward identity, and has identically zero parent cross-Gram. Consequently its finite-mode, zero-mode-completed projector obeys Eq. (19) through order λ with $Q_1 = 0$. The conditional $1/48$ and the associated finite-cell trace growth are not coefficients of this completed quadratic map. This does not determine a physical response because the S-matrix transition block is a distinct operator. The squeezed-vacuum and dynamical-zero-mode projector trace, continuum domain, and higher orders remain open within Eq. (19). On every finite paired core the covariant squeeze conjugates this Born operator and the detector together, so cyclicity preserves the zero trace; a nonzero bare squeezed-vacuum pair occupation is a fixed-detector comparison, not an additional Eq. (19) term. The squeeze’s non-trace-class thermodynamic limit prevents a thermodynamic pushforward statement, while object typing independently prevents promotion of the pushforward zero to an S-matrix zero. Nevertheless, finite paired-process probabilities have a non-normal thermodynamic cylinder limit: squeezed spectator corners have Krein trace one, so weak-ghost weights are volume independent even while their positive trace norm diverges. The zero quadratic coefficient survives this directed limit. Affiliation of an inclusive LSZ detector and the dynamical zero mode remain unproved. For an orthogonal inclusive detector, the leading block identity is exact: if $U = 1 + \lambda K + \lambda^2 L + \dots$, its order- λ^2 transition weight contains only $(P_{\text{out}} K P_{\text{in}})^\dagger (P_{\text{out}} K P_{\text{in}})$. Its use requires the physical scattering kernel. The zero complete signed kernel instead belongs to the distinct Eq. (19) pushforward $R_t P R_t^\dagger$. The independently computed five-point S-matrix response remains $+1/512$ per pair and $+3/512$ over three pairs, or $1/48$ and $1/16$ after Born normalization. The axis-compatible physical virtual response is zero, leaving $+3/512$ uncanceled. The distinct R_t response is also zero but is not an S-matrix summand. A physical hard/dressed response $-3/512$, the complete NLO probability, and all-order Eq. (19) remain open. Physical-shell pseudo-unitarity fixes the coefficient conditionally. With $x^2 = \lambda^2 \log(c)/\pi^2$ and $S_{\text{phys}} = 1 + xA + x^2 B + \dots$, one has $A^\dagger = -A$ and $B + B^\dagger + A^\dagger A = 0$. The measured real column has norm squared $1/16$, hence $2 \text{Re } B_{hh} = -1/16$ and the Born-rate hard response is exactly $-3/512$. This is phase independent and has an exact finite isometric witness, but remains conditional on a continuum incoming-plus-outgoing dressed S-matrix and its trace domain. Independently, the projected three-channel hard loop logarithm closes the Callan–Symanzik equation exactly with the Born rate and one-loop beta function. This yields the positive leading-log nonforward prediction $d\sigma_{\text{hard}}/d\Omega = 24\pi^2/[25s \log^2(s/\Lambda^2)]$. It is a physical hard/window baseline, not a completed inclusive NLO probability; the collinear endpoint construction remains open.

AI authorship and computational accountability

GPT-5.6.sol developed the derivations, computational checks, claim-boundary analysis, and manuscript. Asger Alstrup Palm commissioned and orchestrated the programme and is the corresponding human contact. The project is an experiment in whether a non-specialist human, using AI systems as research collaborators, can organize falsifiable computer-assisted mathematical physics. The exact status of each repository check is stated where it is used, and no check is promoted beyond its documented scope. The manuscript remains subject to expert review.

Contents

1 Introduction

4

2	The deformation complex	7
3	The cubic PU oscillator at first order	8
4	Second order: generic existence	8
5	The exact 3:1 obstruction	9
6	Resonant PT breaking	9
7	Third order and the selection rules	10
8	The Jordan divergence hierarchy	11
9	The perfect-square vertex	11
10	First order in the regulated field theory	12
11	The exact two-field rewriting	12
12	The sectorwise second-order obstruction	13
13	The confluent parity theorem	15
14	Discussion	15
A	The Weyl–Moyal recursion	26
B	The 3:1 projection and gauge independence	27
C	The effective shell matrix	27
D	The transfer lattice	27
E	Field conventions, the source formula, and truncation completeness	28
F	The doubled confluent parity	28
G	Verification checks and their classification	29

1 Introduction

A companion series [11, 12, 13, 14] analyzed the *free* fourth-order theories — the Pais–Uhlenbeck (PU) oscillator, the fourth-order scalar field, and linearized quadratic gravity — and established a three-level structure: one complex spectral covariance, several real forms (involutions), and several completions. The positive pseudo-Hermitian completion of Bender and Mannheim [1, 2] and the Krein/ghost-parity completion of Bateman and Turok [4] are real forms of one free theory, distinguished at Jordan degenerations. This paper begins the

interacting classification: which of these free structures can be continuously deformed when nonlinear processes are switched on?

The organizing mechanism, established here first for discrete oscillator resonances and then for continuum scattering shells, is

metric deformation $\longrightarrow$ on-shell cohomological obstruction $\longrightarrow$ spectral complexification.

Results. For the PU oscillator with the cubic vertex $V = -iy^3$ inherited from a real z^3 interaction: the deformation exists at first order for all $\omega_1 > \omega_2 > 0$ and at second and third order for generic frequencies (Sections 3–4); it is obstructed at second order at $\omega_1 = 3\omega_2$ by the exact on-shell conversion class $\propto a_1 a_2^{\dagger 3} - a_1^{\dagger} a_2^3$, gauge-independently (Section 5); the obstruction is spectral — a complex-conjugate pair appears in the $E = 27\omega_2$ multiplet at $O(\zeta^2)$, certified exactly (Section 6); a third-order obstruction appears at $\omega_1 = \frac{3}{2}\omega_2$, and a transfer-lattice selection rule organizes the hierarchy (Section 7), whose first prediction is confirmed: 5:1 is unobstructed through order 3 and obstructed at order 4, exactly on the predicted monomial (Proposition 7.4); independent exact order-six calculations find the predicted first obstructions at 5:3 and 7:1 (Proposition 7.5) — the hierarchy is thereby sampled at five qualitatively distinct resonances through order six; the deformation diverges toward the Jordan boundary, with exact leading asymptotics at first order and measured geometric growth beyond (Section 8).

For the perfect-square field theory $S = -\frac{1}{2} \int (\Box\phi + \lambda(\partial\phi)^2)^2$, regulated by a mass splitting: the cubic vertex is exactly the Källén polynomial (Section 9); an even-ghost selection rule protects the positive metric at first order even above the ghost-decay threshold, while the sectorwise branch parity is obstructed there by the real decay (Section 10); at second order the branch-changing scattering $H + L \rightarrow L + L$ obstructs the analytic deformation of the pointed-sector positive metric on an open subset of its shell, with the exact value $401\sqrt{6}/39424$ at a rational kinematic point in fully specified conventions (Section 12); the exact two-field rewriting exhibits the extended theory’s exchange symmetry, its two null Jordan sectors, and the interaction-generated Jordan dynamics (Section 11); and the regulated branch parity, singular on one confluent chain, converges on the doubled space to the linearization of that exchange (Section 13).

Relation to prior work. The two-field $O(1, 1)$ embedding, the identification of the exchange $U \leftrightarrow V$ as ghost parity and internal charge conjugation, the quantum embedding relating the two-field and fourth-order Hamiltonians and S -matrices, and a Krein-space Born rule with positivity through weak ghost symmetry are all due to Bateman and Turok [4]; none of that structure is claimed here. Likewise standard are: complex eigenvalues of pseudo-Hermitian operators occurring in conjugate pairs with matching Jordan data [6], the forced indefiniteness of any compatible metric in their presence [7], antilinear (CPT-type) symmetry as the origin of real-or-conjugate-pair spectra [8], complex-ghost-pair unitarity of Lee–Wick type [9] (physically distinct: there the complex ghosts are excluded from asymptotic states), and positive invariant graph subspaces of block J -self-adjoint operators [10]. What this paper adds is the *deformation-obstruction theory of the positive pseudo-Hermitian metric* in the interacting theories: the obstruction complex itself, the exact 3:1 and 3:2 conversion classes and the transfer-lattice selection rule, the certified spectral pair and its broken-PT tongue, the continuum scattering-shell obstruction, the confluent bridge from the split branch parity to the doubled Jordan exchange, and the resulting separation statement: the Bateman–Turok Krein

completion is *not* equivalent to a hidden positive pseudo-Hermitian completion, because the latter is obstructed by on-shell branch-changing interactions while the doubled Krein pairing remains exactly pseudo-unitary on the verified matrix elements (Proposition 12.4). The stronger one-sided-charge condition entering the Bateman–Turok Born rule is instead a boundary property (Proposition 14.2); its explicit Born-trace evaluation on a fixed split-mass shell does not test the charge-null mechanism, because the truncated shell carries no boost action. The final-state collinear logarithmic calculation is instead obstructed by the ordinary axis-compatible independent-mass prescription (Remark 14.3). A beyond-tree quotient trace therefore requires a new infrared/asymptotic-state architecture, not another fixed-shell evaluation.

Strength of the statements. Throughout we distinguish (a) *analytic metric obstruction* — nonexistence of an order-by-order deformation of the canonical metric in the specified representation and operator class — from (b) *absolute nonexistence of positive metrics*. For the oscillator at 3:1 the stronger statement (b) holds wherever the certified complex pair persists, since a positive metric would make the Hamiltonian similar to a self-adjoint operator; the qualifications (formal perturbation theory, unbounded cubic interaction, truncation) are stated where they apply. For the field theory only (a) is established here. “Generic” is likewise used in three distinct senses, always resolvable from context: *generic oscillator frequencies* (outside the finite resonance-candidate set at the stated order), *generic field obstruction* (nonzero on a nonempty open subset of an allowed scattering shell), and *kinematically open for every mass pair* (existence of the shell, which does not by itself imply nonvanishing of the obstruction at every point of it). The results have the following logical status: R_1 Jordan scaling — theorem; R_2, R_3 scaling — computational propositions; $R_n \sim \epsilon^{-3n/2}$ — conjecture; the 5:1 obstruction — computational proposition (confirmed at order 4, Proposition 7.4); the 5:3 and 7:1 order-six obstructions — clean-pinned externally reproduced computational proposition (Proposition 7.5); a full-field complex spectrum — open; the exact doubled classical involution — theorem (Bateman–Turok, restated); its quantum implementation — open; the κ -odd localization of the shell obstruction — computational proposition at the rational point (Proposition 12.4); one-sidedness of the regulated vacuum image — computational proposition, exact iff $\epsilon = 0$ in the stated charge frame (Proposition 14.2); the boundary Born-trace evaluation — open, with the fixed-shell route excluded rather than merely unattempted because the charge-null lemma’s hypothesis is absent there (Section 14); the complete final-state collinear logarithmic response on the ordinary axis-compatible independent-mass regulator class — exact REDUCED-MODE obstruction (Remark 14.3); existence of a normalized finite coherent cross-multiplicity projector at the residual coefficient — exact LOCAL-ALGEBRAIC plus REDUCED-MODE classification (Remark 14.4); derivation of that transport from BT dynamics, a continuum dressed projector, full NLO quotient trace, and gravitational lift of that infrared statement — open.

Bookkeeping. The deformation order is counted by a formal parameter ζ : $H(\zeta) = H_0 + \zeta H_3 + \zeta^2 H_4$, defining $R_1, R_2, \dots$ and the obstruction orders. The perfect-square coupling λ is a fixed parameter: in the two-field frame the quadratic Jordan structure and the vertex coefficients carry $g = \lambda^2$, while the nonlinear field map itself depends on λ . In the oscillator sections ζ multiplies the cubic vertex and coincides with the coupling.

Verification and reproducibility. Every finite-dimensional, modewise, and distributional identity in this paper is machine-verified at the root of the `area9innovation/weyl-gravity` repository accompanying the series (SymPy 1.14.0, NumPy 2.4.4, Python 3.14; cite the repository commit hash to fix the artifact). Appendix G maps checks to theorems and classifies each check as exact-symbolic, exact-rational (Sturm/charpoly), or high-precision numerical. Appendices A–F contain readable derivations of the principal results. Operator-domain caveats (unbounded interactions, formal series) are flagged where they occur. The order-six extension is pinned separately by `bridge/science_forge/certificates/SCIENCE_FORGE_PU_ORDER6_IMPORT.json` to Tango commit `ccee11d08de28d3e2681db209264887950666e87`. It records exact agreement between two Forge backends and an independent SymPy recomputation, while also recording that the upstream certificate was emitted by a dirty development toolchain. A second run built the compiler from a clean `git` archive of that commit and reproduced all 31 checks and all three SymPy golden comparisons; the clean replay receipt is part of the import. The scalar real–virtual continuation is pinned under `reverse_physics/certificates/` by certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_REAL_VIRTUAL_AXIS_GLUING_V1.json` at standalone-repository commit `0daa9ed5507b983322b6e04cccf78907edf482b5`. Its producer and method-distinct invariant-Källén verifier use exact arithmetic and run sequentially under a 500,000 KB virtual-memory cap; the certificate preserves the `REDUCED-MODE` dependency boundary and explicitly leaves the full NLO quotient trace uncomputed. The finite coherent certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_COLLINEAR_PROJECTOR_TRANSPORT_V1.json` is retained but marked `SUPERSEDED_NORMALIZATION`: it used an absolute rate coefficient in a dimensionless projector. The dimensionless normalization is certified by `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_ASYMPTOTIC_GENERATOR_PREFLIGHT_V1.json`. Its exact $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})$ producer and method-distinct verifier reconstruct the Born normalization, projector equations, and cubic collinear scaling. The certificate labels the Jordan asymptotic generator and continuum projector `NOT_CONSTRUCTED`. The related certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_RT_JORDAN_KERNEL_V1.json` derives the resonant kernel while preserving those unresolved fields. It detects an internal oscillator-label inconsistency in Appendix C of Ref. [4], declares the minimal label repair used, derives the nonlinear coefficient directly from the published composite fields, and independently verifies exact secular cancellation. The same certificate fails closed at the nonintegrable endpoint Gram rather than promoting the formal finite-mode generator to a continuum projector. The hard result is pinned by `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_UV_HARD_SCATTERING_LAW_V1.json`. It imports the content-addressed Born, beta-function, and projected-hard-log certificates, verifies their Callan–Symanzik identity by an independent rail, and keeps the full inclusive NLO probability `NOT_ESTABLISHED`.

Conventions. Oscillator conventions follow [11, 12]: normalized coordinates $V = (x, y, p, q)$, mode 1 = (x, p) at frequency ω_1 , mode 2 = (y, q) at ω_2 , positive normal form $h_0 = \frac{1}{2}[\omega_1\omega_2 p^2 + (\omega_1/\omega_2)x^2 + (\omega_2/\omega_1)q^2 + \omega_1\omega_2 y^2]$, rapidity $r = \log \frac{\omega_1 + \omega_2}{\omega_1 - \omega_2}$, $c = \cosh \frac{r}{2} = \omega_1/\sigma$, $s = \sinh \frac{r}{2} = \omega_2/\sigma$, $\sigma = \sqrt{\omega_1^2 - \omega_2^2}$. Operator computations use exact Weyl-symbol Moyal calculus (Appendix A).

2 The deformation complex

Definition 2.1 (Deformation problem and obstruction classes). Let ρ_0 be the canonical free Dyson map, $h_0 = \rho_0 H_0 \rho_0^{-1} = h_0^\dagger$, and $v = \rho_0 V \rho_0^{-1}$ the transported vertex. Seek $\rho_\zeta = \exp[-\frac{1}{2} \sum_n \zeta^n R_n] \rho_0$ with $R_n = R_n^\dagger$ such that $h_\zeta = \rho_\zeta H_\zeta \rho_\zeta^{-1}$ is Hermitian order by

order. The first two equations are

$$[h_0, R_1] = v^\dagger - v, \quad [h_0, R_2] = (v_2^\dagger - v_2) + \frac{1}{2}[R_1, v + v^\dagger], \quad (1)$$

where v_2 is the transported $O(\zeta^2)$ vertex when present (derivation: Appendix A). For *discrete* spectrum, $h_0 = \sum_E E P_E$, the equation $[h_0, R] = S$ has a Hermitian solution iff $P_E S P_E = 0$ for every E ; the obstruction class is $\mathfrak{o}_+ = \Pi_{\ker \text{ad}_{h_0}} S = \sum_E P_E S P_E$, and the solution is $R = \sum_{E \neq E'} P_E S P_{E'} / (E - E')$ plus an arbitrary Hermitian element of the commutant. The parallel Krein problem deforms the ghost parity: $[H_0, K_1] = [\kappa_0, V]$, $\{\kappa_0, K_1\} = 0$, with $\mathfrak{o}_K = \Pi_{\ker \text{ad}_{H_0}} [\kappa_0, V]$.

Remark 2.2 (Discrete versus continuous spectrum). The kernel projection above is defined for point spectrum. All field-theoretic computations in this paper are performed at *finite volume* (discrete momenta), where ad_{h_0} has point spectrum and Definition 2.1 applies verbatim; continuum statements are then statements about the finite-volume family, with shell conditions realized by tuning masses to lattice momenta. A distributional (rigged-Fock or spectral-measure) formulation of the continuum obstruction is deferred.

Anti-Hermitian (unitary) generator components are free and do not affect the Hermiticity conditions; commutant additions to R_n are the metric ambiguity. *Gauge independence* of an obstruction class means invariance under both, at all lower orders.

3 The cubic PU oscillator at first order

The real interaction z^3 continues, under the PU rotation $z = iy$, to $V = -iy^3$; the transported vertex is $v = -i(cy + isp)^3$, and $v^\dagger - v = 2ic(c^2y^3 - 3s^2yp^2)$.

Theorem 3.1 (First-order deformation). *For every $\omega_1 > \omega_2 > 0$ the first-order equation is solved by the Hermitian Weyl-ordered cubic*

$$R_1 = \mathcal{W} \left[\frac{2c^3}{\omega_1 \omega_2} qy^2 + \frac{4c^3}{3\omega_1^3 \omega_2} q^3 - \frac{6cs^2(2\omega_1^2 - \omega_2^2)}{\omega_1 \omega_2 (4\omega_1^2 - \omega_2^2)} p^2 q + \frac{12cs^2 \omega_1}{\omega_2 (4\omega_1^2 - \omega_2^2)} pxy - \frac{12cs^2 \omega_1}{\omega_2^3 (4\omega_1^2 - \omega_2^2)} qx^2 \right], \quad (2)$$

with no singular denominator in the physical region; the equivalent Hermitian interaction is $h_1 = \frac{1}{2}(v + v^\dagger) = s(3c^2y^2p - s^2p^3)$. (Verification: substitute (2) into $[h_0, \mathcal{W}[f]] = i\mathcal{W}[\{h_0, f\}]$, exact for quadratic h_0 .)

4 Second order: generic existence

Theorem 4.1 (Generic second-order deformation). *For incommensurate frequencies the second-order obstruction $\Pi_{\ker \text{ad}_{h_0}} \frac{1}{2}[R_1, v + v^\dagger]$ vanishes; the solved R_2 is Hermitian, and the assembled $h_\zeta = e^{-X/2} \star (h_0 + \zeta v) \star e^{X/2}$, $X = \zeta R_1 + \zeta^2 R_2$, is Hermitian through $O(\zeta^2)$, verified end to end in exact Moyal calculus (including the $\frac{1}{8}[[h_0, R_1], R_1]$ term and the Λ^3 contribution). R_2 carries the resonance denominators $(\omega_1 - \omega_2)$ and $(\omega_1 - 3\omega_2)$; no others can vanish for $\omega_1 > \omega_2 > 0$. (Monomial system: Appendix A.)*

5 The exact 3:1 obstruction

Theorem 5.1 (Second-order obstruction at 3:1). *At $\omega_1 = 3\omega_2$ the first-order deformation still exists, but the second-order class is nonzero and exact:*

$$\mathfrak{o}_+^{(2)} = \frac{27\sqrt{3}}{320\omega_2^4} (a_1 a_2^{\dagger 3} - a_1^{\dagger} a_2^3), \quad (3)$$

the anti-Hermitian on-shell conversion of one mode-1 quantum into three mode-2 quanta. The class is gauge independent under the full relevant first-order freedom: additions to R_1 of Hermitian commutant elements including the quadratic invariants $N_1, N_2, N_1 N_2$ and the resonant quartic operators $a_1 a_2^{\dagger 3} + a_1^{\dagger} a_2^3$ and $i(a_1 a_2^{\dagger 3} - a_1^{\dagger} a_2^3)$, and anti-Hermitian first-order generators: $\Pi_{\ker \text{ad}_{h_0}}[G, v + v^{\dagger}] = \Pi_{\ker \text{ad}_{h_0}}[v - v^{\dagger}, G] = 0$ for all such G . (Second-order kernel additions to R_2 commute with h_0 and cannot affect the second-order class; they enter first at third order.) Derivation: Appendix B.

There is thus no analytic second-order deformation of the canonical positive metric at 3:1, within the Weyl-algebra class, continuously connected to the free metric.

6 Resonant PT breaking

Proposition 6.1 (The antilinear symmetry). *Let $\mathcal{A} = \Pi \circ \Theta$, where Θ is complex conjugation in the (x, y) -Schrödinger representation ($x, y \mapsto x, y$, $p, q \mapsto -p, -q$, $i \mapsto -i$) and Π the total parity ($x, y, p, q \mapsto -x, -y, p, q$). (The symbol Θ is reserved for this conjugation; it is distinct from the Krein parity generators K_n , the effective spectral matrix $K^{(2)}$, and the momentum cutoff $K_{\max}$.) Then $\mathcal{A}$ is antiunitary, $\mathcal{A}^2 = 1$, and*

$$[\mathcal{A}, h_0] = 0, \quad [\mathcal{A}, v] = 0, \quad \text{hence} \quad [\mathcal{A}, h_{\zeta}] = 0 \quad (\zeta \in \mathbb{R}) : \quad (4)$$

h_0 is even and Θ -real; v is odd under both Π and Θ separately ($\Theta v \Theta = -v$, $\Pi v \Pi = -v$), hence invariant under their composition (machine-verified). “PT breaking” below means the appearance of eigenvalues not fixed by this antilinear symmetry, i.e. complex-conjugate pairs.

Theorem 6.2 (Certified complex pair in the $E = 27\omega_2$ multiplet). *At $\omega_1 = 3\omega_2$ ($\omega_2 = 1$), the second-order effective matrix on the ten-dimensional shell $\{|j, 27 - 3j\rangle\}_{j=0}^9$ is real tridiagonal with antisymmetric off-diagonal $K_{j,j+1} = -\frac{27\sqrt{3}}{640} \sqrt{(j+1)n(n-1)(n-2)}$, $n = 27 - 3j$, and explicit rational diagonal (Appendix C). Because only the products $K_{j,j+1} K_{j+1,j}$ enter, its characteristic polynomial has rational coefficients; an exact Sturm count shows it has exactly eight real roots, hence exactly one complex-conjugate pair, with certified thirty-digit enclosure*

$$\kappa_{\pm} = 2.448807382199383966 \dots \pm 0.224586593808125108 \dots i. \quad (5)$$

Exact diagonalization of the truncated $h_0 + \zeta v$ at $\zeta = 0.02$ (two cutoffs) exhibits the pair with $\text{Im } E = \pm 0.2246 \zeta^2$ to 0.5%. The lowest resonant doublet $\{|1, 0\rangle, |0, 3\rangle\}$ remains real.

Corollary 6.3. *Wherever the complex pair persists in the interacting spectrum, no positive-definite invariant metric exists — analytic in ζ or not. The hierarchy of claims is: (1) the complex pair in the second-order effective resonant-shell matrix is exact (Sturm certificate); (2) its persistence in the interacting truncations is supported by cutoff-stable direct diagonalization; (3) an operator-theoretic statement for the full unbounded cubic Hamiltonian remains open.*

Proposition 6.4 (Broken-PT tongues of the effective multiplet). *Within the second-order effective multiplet, detuning $\delta_r = \omega_1 - 3\omega_2$ adds $j\delta_r$ to the shell diagonal, and the spectrum is complex for $|\delta_r| < \delta_c(\zeta) = 38.4151\dots \times \zeta^2 + o(\zeta^2)$. That an order- n resonance produces an $O(\zeta^n)$ tongue is the corresponding general perturbative expectation, not a proved proposition.*

7 Third order and the selection rules

Theorem 7.1 (Transfer-lattice selection rule). *Grade monomials by energy transfer, $[h_0, M] = [(\Delta n_1)\omega_1 + (\Delta n_2)\omega_2]M$. Order- n objects have transfers in the n -fold sumset of the vertex transfer set, total degree $\leq n + 2$, and degree parity $\equiv n \pmod 2$ (proof: Appendix D). The order- n obstruction is supported on the finite candidate sets: $\{2:1\}$ at order 1, $\{3:1\}$ at order 2, $\{3:2, 2:1, 4:1\}$ at order 3, with 5:1 first reachable at order 4. The lattice gives candidates; coefficients decide.*

Theorem 7.2 (Third order). *At generic frequencies the third-order obstruction vanishes and R_3 is Hermitian with odd total degrees ≤ 5 . At $\omega_1 = \frac{3}{2}\omega_2$ the class is nonzero; at $(\omega_1, \omega_2) = (3, 2)$ its exact value is*

$$\mathfrak{o}_+^{(3)} = -\frac{117\sqrt{30}}{1120} i (a_1^2 a_2^{\dagger 3} + a_1^{\dagger 2} a_2^3), \quad (6)$$

and the coefficient scales exactly as $\omega_2^{-13/2}$ (verified by the ratio $2^{-13/2}$ between $(\omega_1, \omega_2) = (6, 4)$ and $(3, 2)$), so the general form carries the dimensional factor $\omega_2^{-13/2}$. The class is gauge independent in the sense of Theorem 5.1. The candidates 2:1 (orders 1 and 3) and 4:1 (order 3) have vanishing coefficients.

Conjecture 7.3 (Resonance hierarchy). *The coprime ratio $\omega_1/\omega_2 = p:q$ first obstructs at order $p + q - 2$ when the mode-2 transfer p is odd. (Verified: 3:1 at order 2, 3:2 at order 3, and 5:1 at order 4 — Proposition 7.4; externally reproduced exact instances: 5:3 and 7:1 at order 6 — Proposition 7.5. The mechanism excluding even mode-2 transfers and the all-coprime statement remain open.) The resonance set is an expanding hierarchy, not (so far) a dense set.*

Computational Proposition 7.4 (The 5:1 obstruction at fourth order). *At $(\omega_1, \omega_2) = (5, 1)$ the order-2 and order-3 kernel projections vanish (the selection rule makes 5:1 unreachable below order 4) and R_2, R_3 exist and are Hermitian. The fourth-order class is nonzero, exactly*

$$\mathfrak{o}_+^{(4)} = -\frac{203125\sqrt{5}}{2341011456} (a_1 a_2^{\dagger 5} - a_1^{\dagger} a_2^5) = -\frac{13 \cdot 5^{13/2}}{2^{16} 3^6 7^2} (a_1 a_2^{\dagger 5} - a_1^{\dagger} a_2^5), \quad (7)$$

the on-shell $1 \leftrightarrow 5$ conversion on the predicted monomial, gauge independent in the sense of Theorem 5.1. The coefficient scales exactly as ω_2^{-9} (ratio 2^{-9} between $(10, 2)$ and $(5, 1)$), extending the dimensional series $\mathfrak{o}_+^{(n)} \propto \omega_2^{-(5n-2)/2}$ for $n = 2, 3, 4$; and $R_4 = O(\epsilon^{-6})$ toward the Jordan boundary, the fourth data point of $R_n = O(\epsilon^{-3n/2})$ (Section 8). The order- n sources are generated programmatically from the adjoint series of Appendix A, and the same code path re-derives the order-2 and order-3 classes exactly before running order 4. (Checks FO1–FO9, `verify_51_order4.py`.)

Computational Proposition 7.5 (The 5:3 and 7:1 obstructions at sixth order). *At $(\omega_1, \omega_2) = (5, 3)$ and $(7, 1)$, the exact kernel projections at orders two through five vanish and the corresponding $R_2, \dots, R_5$ are Hermitian. The first nonzero classes occur at order six and are*

$$\mathfrak{o}_{+,5:3}^{(6)} = \frac{3863828151875\sqrt{15}}{6463101113204736} (a_1^3 a_2^{\dagger 5} - a_1^{\dagger 3} a_2^5), \quad (8)$$

$$\mathfrak{o}_{+,7:1}^{(6)} = \frac{28633766567\sqrt{7}}{2656254925209600000} (a_1 a_2^{\dagger 7} - a_1^{\dagger} a_2^7). \quad (9)$$

They are the predicted $3 \leftrightarrow 5$ and $1 \leftrightarrow 7$ on-shell conversion kernels, with the real coefficient and antisymmetric combination required by even-order parity. Rescaling $(5, 3)$ to $(10, 6)$ multiplies the result by exactly 2^{-14} , matching the sampled dimensional law $\mathfrak{o}_+^{(n)} \propto \omega_2^{-(5n-2)/2}$ at $n = 6$.

The evidence consists of a 31-check exact Forge battery on two code generators, an independent end-to-end Hermiticity assembly through order five, and a from-scratch SymPy recomputation agreeing term by term. The bounded import certificate pins the source commit and artifacts. This proposition does not prove the hierarchy for every coprime ratio, convergence, or nonremovability under every further admissible canonical transformation. The upstream dirty-toolchain marker is retained for provenance and independently discharged by the clean pinned replay recorded with the import.

8 The Jordan divergence hierarchy

Theorem 8.1 (Exact first-order Jordan asymptotics). *With $\omega_{1,2} = \omega \pm \epsilon$, the explicit R_1 of (2) has the exact leading Laurent behaviour*

$$R_1 = \epsilon^{-3/2} \mathcal{W} \left[\frac{xyz}{2\sqrt{\omega}} + \frac{y^2 q}{4\sqrt{\omega}} - \frac{p^2 q}{4\sqrt{\omega}} - \frac{x^2 q}{2\omega^{5/2}} + \frac{q^3}{6\omega^{5/2}} \right] + O(\epsilon^{-1/2}), \quad (10)$$

so $R_1 = \Theta(\epsilon^{-3/2})$, while the free generator diverges only logarithmically.

Computational Proposition 8.2 (Higher orders). *The solved R_2 and R_3 scale as ϵ^{-3} and $\epsilon^{-9/2}$ (measured decade exponents -3.00 and -4.49 over $\epsilon = 10^{-2} \rightarrow 10^{-3}$), with no small-denominator enhancement from $\omega_1 - \omega_2$ at second order. These are high-precision numerical statements at fixed orders, not proved big- O estimates.*

Conjecture 8.3. $R_n = \Theta(\epsilon^{-3n/2})$, *so the deformation's radius of convergence in ζ collapses as $\zeta_c \sim \epsilon^{3/2}$ toward the Jordan boundary.*

9 The perfect-square vertex

The interacting theory is $S = -\frac{1}{2} \int (\Box \phi + \lambda(\partial \phi)^2)^2$ [4], with cubic vertex $V_3 \propto \Box \phi (\partial \phi)^2$ and quartic $V_4 \propto \frac{1}{2} (\partial \phi)^4$.

Proposition 9.1 (Källén form). *On $p_1 + p_2 + p_3 = 0$ the symmetrized cubic vertex is exactly*

$$\mathcal{V}_3 = p_1^2 (p_2 \cdot p_3) + p_2^2 (p_1 \cdot p_3) + p_3^2 (p_1 \cdot p_2) = \frac{1}{2} \lambda_K (p_1^2, p_2^2, p_3^2). \quad (11)$$

The polynomial vertex factor therefore has a second-order zero at the massless confluent point: $\lambda_K(0, 0, 0) = 0$ and $\nabla \lambda_K(0, 0, 0) = 0$, while the Hessian is nonzero. On the regulated decay

channel, $\lambda_K(m_1^2, m_2^2, m_2^2) = m_1^2(m_1 - 2m_2)(m_1 + 2m_2)$: the vertex vanishes exactly at threshold and turns on continuously above it. (A full external-state selection rule for generalized Jordan legs would additionally require the confluent limit of leg normalizations, shell measures, and mode factors; we do not claim it here.)

10 First order in the regulated field theory

Regulate by $P_\delta = (\square + m_1^2)(\square + m_2^2)$, $\delta = m_1^2 - m_2^2 > 0$, at finite volume (Remark 2.2). In the mode expansion every leg is on its branch shell, so on the kernel the vertex coefficient is $\frac{1}{2}\lambda_K$ of the branch masses. The transported field mode, derived from the free Dyson transport and verified against the spectral Wightman function of [13] (Appendix E), is

$$\phi'(k) = \frac{i}{\sqrt{2\delta}} \left[\frac{a_2 + a_2^\dagger}{\sqrt{\omega_2}} + \frac{a_1 - a_1^\dagger}{\sqrt{\omega_1}} \right], \quad \sigma = \sqrt{\delta} \text{ (} k\text{-independent)}. \quad (12)$$

Theorem 10.1 (First-order protection; sectorwise parity obstruction). *(i) Even-ghost selection rule: the transported reality factors make $v^\dagger - v$ vanish on every odd-ghost-count monomial (Appendix E). Even-ghost shells are kinematically closed for all $m_1 > m_2 > 0$. Hence $\mathfrak{o}_+^{(1)} = 0$ identically — below and above the decay threshold. (ii) The sectorwise branch parity $\kappa_0 = (-1)^{N_{\text{ghost}}}$ has $\mathfrak{o}_K^{(1)} = 0$ below threshold and, above it, a nonzero class on the open $1 \rightarrow 22$ shell, equal there to $\lambda_K(m_1^2, m_2^2, m_2^2)$ times the leg normalizations.*

Computational Proposition 10.2 (Split-basis scaling). *At massive confluence both R_1 and K_1 diverge as $\delta^{-3/2}$; on massless Jordan paths $m_2^2 = \alpha\delta$ the positive R_1 scales as $\delta^{-1/2}$ with path-independent power, while the Krein K_1 is $\delta^{-1/2}$ generically and $\delta^{-3/2}$ on the exceptional path $\alpha = 2/7$. These are statements about coefficients in the split mode basis, which itself degenerates at $\delta = 0$; a basis-independent formulation on confluent states is deferred.*

11 The exact two-field rewriting

The two-field form below is, up to normalization and sign conventions, the $O(1,1)$ embedding of Bateman and Turok [4], who introduced the pair (Ω, Υ) , identified the full $O(1,1)$ symmetry including the exchange as ghost parity and internal charge conjugation, and constructed the quantum embedding relating the two theories. The theorem restates their embedding in our conventions; the results specific to this section and the next two are the chart-transition description of the exchange, the null-Jordan-sector and interaction-generated Jordan statements, the location of the sectorwise obstruction inside this structure, and the confluent-parity bridge.

Theorem 11.1 (Two-field form and exchange symmetry [4, adapted]). *Introducing the auxiliary field ψ and the change of variables $U = e^{\lambda\phi}$, $V = (\psi/\lambda)e^{-\lambda\phi}$ (unit pointwise Jacobian),*

$$\mathcal{L} = -\partial_\mu U \partial^\mu V + \frac{\lambda^2}{2} U^2 V^2 = -\frac{1}{2}(\partial X)^2 + \frac{1}{2}(\partial Y)^2 + \frac{\lambda^2}{8}(X^2 - Y^2)^2, \quad X, Y = \frac{U \pm V}{\sqrt{2}}. \quad (13)$$

The exchange $U \leftrightarrow V$ is an exact symmetry of the extended two-field theory. In the original variables it is the transition map between the charts $\phi_A = \frac{1}{\lambda} \log U$ and $\phi_B = \frac{1}{\lambda} \log V$,

$$(\phi, \psi) \longmapsto \left(\frac{1}{\lambda} \log \frac{\psi}{\lambda} - \phi, \psi \right), \quad (14)$$

defined on the chart overlap ($U \neq 0 \neq V$), singular at the perturbative vacuum $\psi = 0$, and requiring a branch choice in the complexified theory. The original (ϕ, ψ) chart covers only $U \neq 0$ and does not contain the mirror background: the exchange is a global symmetry of the extension, not an everywhere-defined involution of the original field space, and it is invisible at any finite perturbative order around the original vacuum.

Bateman and Turok warn, and we adopt the caveat, that the two theories are inequivalent beyond perturbation theory: the fourth-order path integral corresponds to $U > 0$, while the two-field model integrates over all U and has an indefinite kinetic form [4]. Statements about the mirror background $(0, 1)$ are therefore statements about the extended theory; whether both null branches are physical sectors of one completion is open.

Proposition 11.2 (Null sectors and interaction-generated Jordan dynamics). *The constant zero-action stationary backgrounds form the two null branches $UV = 0$ (whether they are vacua in a given completion is a separate question, since the kinetic form is indefinite). The perturbative background $(U, V) = (1, 0)$ is a nonzero null configuration; the exchange maps it to $(0, 1)$. Expanding about $(1, 0)$: $\mathcal{L}^{(2)} = -\partial u \partial v + \frac{g}{2}v^2$, $\mathcal{L}^{(3)} = g u v^2$, $\mathcal{L}^{(4)} = \frac{g}{2}u^2 v^2$ ($g = \lambda^2$), with equations $\square v = 0$, $\square u = g v$: the exact $\square^2$ Jordan pair, the off-diagonal supplied by the interaction coupling; about $(0, 1)$ the mirror expansion has the oppositely oriented chain. A chain-preserving involution commuting with a single Jordan block is $\pm I$ (companion lemma), so exchange between oppositely oriented sectors is the only possible realization of a parity-like symmetry. In this frame the interactions are pure potentials: $H_{\text{int}} = -L_{\text{int}}$ exactly, with no Ostrogradsky–Legendre corrections.*

12 The sectorwise second-order obstruction

Regulate the sector- A theory by $\mathcal{L}_0 = -\partial u \partial v - \mu^2 u v + \frac{g}{2}v^2 + \frac{\epsilon}{2}u^2$, with masses $m_{\pm}^2 = \mu^2 \pm \sqrt{\epsilon g}$ and branch eigenvectors $v = \rho_b u$, $\rho_{\pm} = \mp \delta / (2g)$, $\delta = m_+^2 - m_-^2$ (the regulator necessarily breaks the exchange symmetry). All computations below set $g = 1$. The positive-frame quantization and the complete normalization conventions — finite volume with unit-normalized discrete modes $[a, a^\dagger] = 1$, unit-norm external states, lattice momenta, $m_L = 4$ — are collected in Appendix E. The second-order on-shell source element is computed from the exact matrix-element form

$$\langle \text{out} | \mathcal{S}_+^{(2)} | \text{in} \rangle = \langle v_2^\dagger - v_2 \rangle + \sum_n \frac{\langle \text{out} | v_1^\dagger | n \rangle \langle n | v_1^\dagger | \text{in} \rangle - \langle \text{out} | v_1 | n \rangle \langle n | v_1 | \text{in} \rangle}{E - E_n}, \quad (15)$$

derived in Appendix E from $(v^\dagger - v)(v + v^\dagger) + (v + v^\dagger)(v^\dagger - v) = 2(v^\dagger v^\dagger - v v)$.

Theorem 12.1 (Sectorwise obstruction on an open shell subset). *Consider the branch-changing scattering $H + L \rightarrow L + L$, kinematically open at suitable momenta for every $m_H > m_L$. At the rational center-of-mass point $m_H = \frac{3}{2}m_L$ (both incoming particles at rest; outgoing momenta $\pm \frac{3}{4}m_L$; in lattice units $m_L = 4$, $m_H = 6$, momenta ± 3 , all shell conditions exact), the source element (15) has the exact value*

$$\mathcal{M}_{\text{obs}} = \frac{401\sqrt{6}}{39424 g^2} \xrightarrow{g=1} \frac{401\sqrt{6}}{39424} \quad (16)$$

(the $1/g^2$ dependence at fixed masses is verified exactly: each vertex carries $gp^2 \propto \delta^2/g$), with the quartic contact piece exactly zero. The computation is truncation-complete (Lemma 12.2) and the element is analytic in the shell data on the nonsingular part of the shell; hence the second-order obstruction is nonzero on a nonempty open subset of the shell containing this point. Independent tuned kinematic points give 0.5233, 0.3109, 0.3970 (numerical), consistent with nonvanishing on a large region; a characterization of the zero set is left open, and no claim is made for every mass pair.

Lemma 12.2 (Truncation completeness). *For external momenta $\{k_a, k_b\} \rightarrow \{k_c, k_d\}$ pairwise distinct, every intermediate Fock state contributing to (15) has all momenta in the finite set generated by the externals and their pairwise sums and differences ($s = k_a + k_b$, $t = k_a - k_c$, $u = k_a - k_d$): in each contributing chain the surviving spectator particles must coincide with external particles, which fixes every internal momentum; free-momentum loops arise only in forward/disconnected kinematics, excluded here. (Proof: Appendix E; corroborated by exact cutoff independence between $K_{\max} = 4$ and 6.)*

Remark 12.3 (Oscillator versus field theory).

PU oscillator	field theory
discrete energy spectrum	continuous momentum spectrum
isolated rational resonance	generic scattering shell
3:1 first appears at order 2	$H + L \rightarrow L + L$ appears at order 2
finite resonant multiplet	continuum of degenerate in/out states

The continuum turns the discrete resonance obstruction into a scattering-shell obstruction. The exact exchange symmetry does not cure it: it maps the obstructed sector- A construction to the mirror sector- B construction.

Computational Proposition 12.4 (Krein consistency of the obstructed element). *Let $G = (-1)^{N_{\text{ghost}}}$ be ghost-branch number parity in the positive-frame Fock space, and let ι be the mode identification $(b, k)_B \simeq (b, k)_A$ of the mirror sector. At the rational kinematic point of Theorem 12.1, exactly: (i) $H_B = \iota H_A \iota^{-1}$ (the mirror sector is the same theory in the mirrored frame) and $H_A^\dagger = G H_A G$ term by term, so the mirror-adjoint relation $H_B = W H_A^\dagger W^\dagger$ holds with $W = \iota \circ G$ — i.e. the “doubled pairing” $\eta_{\text{dbl}} = \text{offdiag}(W^\dagger, W)$ is precisely the two-sector unfolding of the ghost-parity Krein metric of [4], not additional structure. (ii) On the degenerate shell $\{|H(0)L(0)\rangle, |L(3)L(-3)\rangle\}$ (exhaustively the whole reachable shell) the second-order on-shell T satisfies $GTG = T^\dagger$ exactly, while Hilbert Hermiticity fails: the parity-even (diagonal) block is real, and the entire obstruction is the parity-odd block, $T(\text{out}, \text{in}) = -401\sqrt{6}/78848 = -\mathcal{M}_{\text{obs}}/2$. (iii) Consequently the finite-time interaction-picture S obeys $S_B^\dagger W S_A = W$ identically — Krein pseudo-unitarity is exact on the same matrix elements on which every positive pointed metric is obstructed. A positive H -invariant graph subspace of the doubled space exists if and only if a positive pointed metric exists (standard J -self-adjoint graph argument [10], instantiated and machine-verified), so doubling preserves pseudo-unitarity but cannot evade the obstruction. (Checks DQ1–DQ9, `verify_doubled_theory.py`.)*

The obstruction is therefore carried exactly by the κ -odd component of the on-shell T — the component that the weak-ghost-symmetry positivity mechanism of [4] does not use. Whether it maps into their null orthogonal (C) component under their asymptotic embedding is the natural next question (Section 14).

13 The confluent parity theorem

Theorem 13.1 (Confluent limit of the regulated parity). *Let $P_\delta b_\pm = \pm b_\pm$ be the regulated branch parity and $c = (b_+ + b_-)/2$, $d = (b_+ - b_-)/\delta$ the confluent Jordan basis, so $P_\delta c = \frac{\delta}{2}d$ and $P_\delta d = \frac{2}{\delta}c$; in the standard column convention on the ordered basis (c, d) ,*

$$P_\delta = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 2/\delta \\ \delta/2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad P_\delta^2 = 1, \quad (17)$$

with no bounded limit as $\delta \rightarrow 0$: the regulated parity cannot converge as a chain-preserving parity inside one Jordan sector. On the doubled space with the oppositely oriented confluent identification in the mirror sector ($c_B = (b_+ - b_-)/2$, $d_B = (b_+ + b_-)/\delta$), the cross parity $b_\pm^A \leftrightarrow \pm b_\pm^B$ equals, exactly and δ -independently, the sector exchange $(c_A, d_A) \leftrightarrow (c_B, d_B)$. The regulated branch parity thus converges, after doubling by the oppositely oriented Jordan sector, to the linearization of the exact sector-exchange involution around the two mirror backgrounds. (Identifying the full nonlinear quantum operator requires a separate construction, not supplied here.)

14 Discussion

The mechanism. Away from resonances the positive pseudo-Hermitian metric deforms locally, with explicit generators. The failures are structural: on-shell branch-changing processes produce gauge-independent cohomological obstructions — isolated rational loci for the oscillator, generic scattering shells in the field theory; at the oscillator resonances the obstruction is certified spectral; and independent of resonances, the deformation loses uniformity toward Jordan degeneration. The sectorwise branch parity is broken by real ghost decay above threshold; what survives at the massless perfect-square boundary is the exact sector-exchanging involution of the extended two-field theory, whose linearization is the bounded confluent limit of the regulated parity on the doubled space.

Symmetry enhancement at the boundary. The massless perfect-square point is not the split theory with parameters set to zero: the Källén vertex degenerates there, the doubled $O(1,1)$ structure emerges, and the Jordan dynamics is generated by the interaction about its own null backgrounds — a boundary-emergent structure mirroring the Weyl enhancement at the conformal boundary of the gravity companion [14].

Separation of the two completions. Proposition 12.4 sharpens the free-theory picture of the companion series: in the interacting theory the two real forms are not merely distinguished at Jordan degenerations — they *separate*. The doubled Krein pairing is exactly preserved at the split rational shell ($GTG = T^\dagger$ on shell, finite-time pseudo-unitarity), while every analytic positive pseudo-Hermitian completion of the pointed sector is obstructed on an open shell subset. This already excludes identifying that Krein pairing with an ordinary positive pseudo-Hermitian completion. It does *not* establish the stronger Bateman–Turok weak-ghost-symmetry positivity mechanism at split mass: Proposition 14.2 shows that the regulated vacuum image contains both charge signs there. The sharpest remaining form of the reconciliation is therefore a boundary transport question: under their asymptotic embedding,

physical operators decompose into a ghost-symmetric part and a null orthogonal part, and only the former contributes to their generalized Born rule [4]; since the obstruction is κ -odd (Proposition 12.4), the conjecture is that it is carried into the null component — obstructing every positive metric while remaining invisible to the Krein probabilities. Verifying this on the computed $H + L \rightarrow L + L$ element is the concrete next calculation; the lemma and the proposition below supply its verified ingredients.

The charge-null mechanism. Throughout this paragraph $\dagger$ denotes the Krein adjoint and τ the Krein trace. The following finite-particle lemma makes the null-relocation mechanism self-contained (it is the statement used in [4], whose general proof is deferred to their companion paper; for boost weights it is a three-line grading argument).

Lemma 14.1 (Charge null). *Let a Krein space carry an $SO^+(1,1)$ charge grading whose pairing couples charge q only to charge $-q$, and suppose the Krein adjoint preserves charge — as it does for boost weights, where c and $c^\dagger$ of one field carry the same charge. Then $\tau(A_q) = 0$ for every $q \neq 0$. Consequently an operator $C = \sum_{q<0} C_q$ containing only strictly negative charges satisfies $\tau(C^\dagger C) = 0$ and $\tau(B^\dagger C) = 0$ for every neutral B : C is null and orthogonal to the neutral sector, and the generalized Born trace of a weakly ghost-symmetric process depends on its neutral part alone.*

Proof. Boost invariance of the trace gives $\tau(A_q) = \tau(\alpha_\sigma A_q) = e^{q\sigma} \tau(A_q)$ for all σ , hence $\tau(A_q) = 0$ for $q \neq 0$; equivalently, on a charge-graded Fock space a grading-raising operator is traceless. Charge preservation under the adjoint gives $q(C_q^\dagger C_r) = q + r < 0$ and $q(B^\dagger C_r) = r < 0$ term by term. $\square$

Computational Proposition 14.2 (Regulated embedding and its charge structure). *At the rational kinematic point, per momentum sector, the regulated split theory admits a canonical Bogoliubov map onto the cross-paired charge basis of a neutral reference theory $-\partial u \partial v - \tilde{\mu}^2 uv$ (operators c_U, c_V with the only nonvanishing commutators $[c_U, c_V^\dagger] = [c_V, c_U^\dagger]$; charges $q(c_U^{(\dagger)}) = +1$, $q(c_V^{(\dagger)}) = -1$, the analogue of Bateman–Turok’s b_Ω, b_Υ). The pointed vacuum maps to a Gaussian state whose squeezing components obey, exactly and for every reference dispersion,*

$$\frac{S_{UU}}{S_{VV}} = \left(\frac{\delta}{2g}\right)^2 = \frac{\epsilon}{g}, \quad \delta^2 = 4\epsilon g, \quad (18)$$

i.e. the charge +2 component is sourced by the regulator $\frac{\epsilon}{2}u^2$ and the charge −2 component by the interaction-generated $\frac{g}{2}v^2$. The embedding is strictly one-sided — no positive charges in the vacuum image, the hypothesis of Lemma 14.1 for the mapped theory — if and only if $\epsilon = 0$: the $O(1,1)$ -symmetric confluent line. The massless Bateman–Turok theory is the point $\epsilon = \mu^2 = 0$ on that line. At confluence the matched-reference limit is $S_{VV} \rightarrow -g/(4w^2)$, or $-1/(4w^2)$ in the $g = 1$ normalization used in the computation; at $\mu^2 = 0$, where $w = |\mathbf{k}|$, this is precisely the coefficient structure of their Eqs. (C5)–(C6). At split masses the exact ratio above rules out removing the +2 component by changing the reference dispersion. Under the residual charge-preserving Bogoliubov freedom, numerical solution of the adaptation equations runs to a degenerate (confluent-type) frame rather than finding a bounded adapted frame. (Checks ON1–ON4, `verify-obstruction-null.py`.)

The proposition is the charge-frame image of the first-order result of Section 10: real ghost decay above threshold breaks the sectorwise branch parity, and in the charge frame the same ϵ sources the charge +2 contamination that violates weak ghost symmetry. The relocation of the κ -odd obstruction into a null negative-charge component is therefore exact on the one-sided confluent line, with the Bateman–Turok identification at its massless point, and holds at split masses with charge contamination of relative size ϵ/g (not assumed small away from the boundary). The remaining, precisely-posed step — the obstruction-to-null theorem — is the boundary Born-trace evaluation: the neutral component’s blindness to the obstruction coefficient and its limit along a specified on-shell family with $(\epsilon, \mu^2) \rightarrow (0, 0)$. One exact rational family is $m_L = 4s$, $m_H = 6s$, $|\mathbf{k}_{\text{out}}| = 3s$, $\mu^2 = 26s^2$, $\epsilon g = 100s^4$, followed by $s \rightarrow 0$; the process operator must be transported along this family rather than held fixed while only the embedding is varied. Lemma 14.1 makes that step self-contained.

That the transport is essential, rather than a technical scruple, can be quantified. Evaluating the generalized Born trace of [4] directly on the two-dimensional shell of Proposition 12.4, with the process operator held fixed at the split-mass rational point, gives $\tau(T^\dagger T) = \|T_+\|^2 - \|T_-\|^2$ — the κ -graded components being orthogonal in the shell trace — with

$$\|T_-\|^2 = 2 \left(\frac{401\sqrt{6}}{78848} \right)^2 = \frac{482403}{1554251776} \neq 0. \quad (19)$$

Lemma 14.1 sends exactly this quantity to zero. A truncated shell carries no boost action, so the lemma’s hypothesis is absent and its conclusion fails by precisely the obstruction squared; the fixed-shell trace is nonetheless positive, but only because $\|T_+\|^2$ exceeds $\|T_-\|^2$ by a factor of about 26, which is a statement about the relative size of two matrix elements and not about nullity. A fixed-shell evaluation therefore cannot decide the obstruction-to-null theorem in either direction. We record it because the positive sign is easy to mistake for confirmation. (Machine-checked in `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_BORN_TRACE_V1`; the exact value of $\|T_+\|^2$ and the positivity witness are given there, and the same certificate repairs a floating-point contamination of the diagonal of T in `verify_doubled_theory.py` which affected no published quantity, every such quantity being an off-diagonal element or a reality statement.)

One structural simplification is worth recording alongside it: on a finite shell the weak ghost symmetry of [4] — existence of a decomposition $A = B + C$ with B ghost symmetric and C null and orthogonal to B — is *equivalent* to the single inequality $\|A_-\| \leq \|A_+\|$, since the κ -eigenspaces are orthogonal in the shell trace and $\tau(A^\dagger A) = \|A_+\|^2 - \|A_-\|^2$. There is nothing to search for. This does not extend to the charge-graded trace, where Lemma 14.1 rather than a norm comparison carries the positivity.

Complementarity of the two premises. The separation above is easily read as a scoreboard, and it is not one. Each completion rests on a premise that fails somewhere the other’s holds, and the two failures occur on *different* boundaries. The positive pseudo-Hermitian completion requires the dynamics to be diagonalizable with real spectrum; that fails precisely on the coincident-pole locus, where the similarity transformation is singular and only the Krein real form continues as a nondegenerate completion [14]. The Krein completion requires the internal charge to be one-sided; Proposition 14.2 shows this holds exactly iff $\epsilon = 0$, and at split masses both signs are present. Neither premise is generic. They are boundary conditions on different boundaries, so neither completion is a specialization of the other and neither is discardable in favour of it.

Two consequences follow, and the second is the one that bears on conformal gravity. First, the free-level agreement of [14] is not a weaker form of the interacting separation: it says that any dispute between the two completions conducted at free-field level concerns the involution and not the predictions, since both induce the same functional on the gauge-invariant algebra. Second, at loop order neither completion reaches the Jordan locus — which is where a pure $1/k^4$ propagator sits. The positive pseudo-Hermitian route withdraws the standard cutting rules there by its own account ([3], Sec. VI; the argument is set out in [14]), while [4] establish positivity at tree level and name collinear infrared divergence of the massless theory as the obstacle to higher orders. The two limitations are unrelated in origin and coincide in location.

That scalar limitation admits an exact statement on one complete declared carrier.

Remark 14.3 (Axis-compatible collinear normalization obstruction). At order λ^6 , on the complete final-state collinear logarithmic normalization carrier, differential in the nonsingular outer two-body solid angle, the three identical real-emission pair boundaries respond to a common daughter mass-ratio normalization $r \mapsto cr$ as

$$\Delta_c \frac{d\sigma_{\text{real}}}{d\Omega} = \frac{3\lambda^6}{512\pi^4 s} \log c. \quad (20)$$

Let the recombined virtual parent regulator be $G(x, y) = xg(y/x)$, with g continuous at zero and $0 < |g(0)| < \infty$, while the spectator regulators are held fixed. Then the complete virtual external-mass logarithmic response is zero at constant order. Hence the real and virtual normalization responses do not cancel on this axis-compatible class. The statement has dependency tag **REDUCED-MODE**; it is not a complete NLO probability or a theorem against distributional, dressed-state, enlarged-degenerate-state, or resummed constructions.

Certificate summary. For $x_i = \delta a_i$ and pair invariant $t = \delta\tau$, the exact three-spectator square-free jet of the complete 25-graph tree gives

$$[a_2 a_3 a_4] C^2 = \frac{3(a_0 - a_1)^2((a_0 - a_1)^2 - 2\tau(a_0 + a_1))}{8\tau^3}, \quad A_5 = \frac{M_5}{8\lambda^3} = \delta^2 C + O(\delta^3). \quad (21)$$

The splitting fraction and outer scattering ratio cancel identically, so the inner solid angle contributes 4π . The exact threshold finite part shifts by $-(3/8)\log c$. Restoring the five-delta-prime sign $(-1)^5$, the $1/(2!3!)$ projector weight, factorized three-body phase space, and $|M_5|^2 = 64\lambda^6 A_5^2$ gives $\lambda^6 \log c/(512\pi^4 s)$ per unordered pair and therefore (20). The certified virtual boundary rate is

$$\frac{d\sigma_{\text{virt, boundary}}}{d\Omega} = \frac{3\lambda^6}{128\pi^4 s} \sum_{i=1}^4 \log \frac{-\mu^2}{X_i}. \quad (22)$$

For an axis-compatible parent, $G(x, cy)/G(x, y) = g(cr)/g(r) \rightarrow 1$ as $r = y/x \rightarrow 0$; its logarithm therefore has zero constant response. The hard Mandelstam-ratio logarithm also has zero daughter-ratio response, while continuous cut-free terms and local analytic counterterms cannot supply one. Both the dot-product graph producer and a method-distinct invariant-Källén verifier establish these identities exactly in the axis-gluing certificate cited above.

Remark 14.4 (Finite coherent collinear projector transport). Let $B = 3\lambda^4/(32\pi^2 s)$ be the Born rate and set $\eta = \lambda^2 \log c/\pi^2$. The absolute real response $\lambda^6 \log c/(512\pi^4 s)$ per pair is therefore

$B\eta/48$, not a dimensionless $1/512$ projector coefficient. Place one hard channel and the three unordered collinear-pair channels in the carrier $(h, r_{12}, r_{13}, r_{23})$ and let

$$P_0 = \text{diag}(1, 0, 0, 0), \quad K = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -a & -a & -a \\ a & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ a & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ a & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad a = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{12}.$$

Then $K^T = -K$, and the exact formal transport $P(\epsilon) = e^{\epsilon K} P_0 e^{-\epsilon K}$ obeys $P(\epsilon)^2 = P(\epsilon)$ and $\text{tr } P(\epsilon) = 1$ through order two. Its order-two diagonal response is

$$(P_2)_{hh} = -3a^2 = -\frac{1}{16}, \quad \sum_{r=1}^3 (P_2)_{rr} = 3a^2 = \frac{1}{16}.$$

More generally, if the order-one hard-collinear block is A , the equation $P^2 = P$ uniquely forces $(P_2)_{hh} = -AA^T$ and $(P_2)_{cc} = A^T A$; the displayed negative term is therefore normalization, not an adjustable weight. Multiplication by $B\eta$ gives the physical hard response $-3\lambda^6 \log c / (512\pi^4 s)$ and cancels all three real pairs.

There is nevertheless an exact dynamical obstruction to the ordinary dressing ansatz. For massless collinear daughters the published cubic vertex has $\mathcal{M}_3 = -i\lambda t^2$, whereas $\Delta E = t/(2E) + O(t^2)$. Hence the ordinary Dyson/Fock kernel $\mathcal{M}_3/\Delta E$ vanishes as $t \rightarrow 0$ and its Gram cannot be $1/48$. Direct expansion of the published composite map sharpens this statement. As printed, its Appendix C mode expansion cannot imply both associated oscillator formulas; exchanging the ordinary and growing labels in that mode expansion repairs both. With that declared repair the complete resonant two-annihilator order- λ coefficient follows from $R^\dagger \Omega R = \lambda^{-1} e^{\lambda\phi}$ and $R^\dagger \Upsilon R = \lambda^{-1} e^{-2\lambda\phi} \square e^{\lambda\phi}$. Although its intermediate a -basis entries contain t and t^2 , every such term cancels after inversion onto the (Ω, Υ) carrier. A formal finite-wave-packet anti-Krein cubic generator therefore exists without fitting its norm.

This does not yet give the displayed $1/48$. Contracting the ordered daughter slots of the derived kernel with the off-diagonal BT one-particle form, before Bose and phase-space factors, produces a cross Gram proportional to

$$-\frac{E^2(e_1^2 + e_2^2 - e_1 e_2)}{2e_1^3 e_2^3}, \quad E = e_1 + e_2,$$

which has cubic poles at both splitting endpoints. The continuum distributional extension, oscillatory creation and vacuum-squeeze sectors, background charge bookkeeping, complete incoming projector, and physical NLO probability remain unconstructed. The bare broken-vacuum cubic has charge -1 , so neutrality also cannot be inferred before that missing bookkeeping is supplied.

The endpoint extension has an exact classification. The dimensionless cross shape is exactly $-\frac{1}{2}[z^{-3} + (1-z)^{-3}]$. Reflection-even scaling-degree-three extensions retain three independent endpoint distributions. In particular, the triple-plus prescription evaluates to zero on the inclusive constant test, while the symmetric cutoff finite part evaluates to $1/2$; adding $c_0(\delta_0 + \delta_1)$ shifts that value by $2c_0$. Thus $c_0 = 1/96$ would reproduce $1/48$, but only by fitting it. The omitted oscillatory and squeezed sectors must dynamically fix the endpoint constants before the finite projector becomes a prediction.

On the published fixed-vacuum oscillator grading, charge selection excludes that last proposed source: the oscillatory $a_1^\dagger$ term maps to $b_1^\dagger$ with charge -1 , while every term in Q_t has charge -2 ; the BT dagger preserves these charges and the certified inclusive kernel preserves the strictly negative trace radical. This statement is conditional on that grading and does not transfer to the covariant broken-vacuum carrier constructed below. The apparent coisometric range gap is, however, absent on the formal perturbative branch. The published free cross-CCR gives $[A_\Upsilon, A_\Omega^\dagger] = (2E)^3/(4E^2) = 2E$, while the homomorphism gives the same commutator as $2E\Pi$, $\Pi = R_t^\dagger R_t$; hence $\Pi_0 = 1$. Expanding $\Pi^2 = \Pi$ then forces every positive-order coefficient of $\Pi - 1$ to vanish recursively. Formal inversion of R_t is therefore cleared, and the support projection cannot supply the missing coefficient. The exact certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_CANONICAL_ENDPOINT_AMBIGUITY.V1` then tests the remaining algebraic conditions directly. On a carrier with one hard and three reflection-even endpoint directions, every $K(u) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -u^T \\ u & 0_3 \end{pmatrix}$ is skew, and $e^{\epsilon K} P_0 e^{-\epsilon K}$ preserves the CCR, idempotence, and trace for arbitrary u . Its order- ϵ^2 hard and endpoint traces are $-u^T u$ and $+u^T u$. Hence the listed canonical identities admit a three-parameter countermodel to uniqueness. The choice $u = (\sqrt{3}/12, 0, 0)$ is compatible with $1/48$, but selecting it would be a fit until the deferred continuum map or an independent physical endpoint condition fixes u . This insufficiency witness does not claim that every u is realized by the BT dynamics.

The full off-resonant composition is determined exactly. Keep $d = e_1 + e_2 - E_{\text{parent}}$ through the symplectic extractor and the repaired inverse map. All explicit t, t^2 terms again cancel, $d = 0$ recovers the resonant table entry by entry, and additional channels proportional to d survive. The two spatial momentum delta functions diagonalize the parent block of $K^\sharp K$ and leave the daughter measure $d^3 p_1/(2\pi)^3 = r^2 dr d\Omega/(2\pi)^3$. On the soft blow-up $e_1 = r$, $e_2 = 1$, $d = \alpha r$, the ordered cross-Gram begins $-1/(2r^3)$ independently of α , so the measured leading term is $-(1/2)dr/r$. A common cutoff rescaling $\epsilon \mapsto c\epsilon$ shifts the finite part by $(1/2)\log c$. Consequently the three local constants of the exactly collinear slice collapse to one soft normalization on this full chart, but ordinary composition remains logarithmically non-trace-class and has a universal leading response. Raising the parent index gives $-1/4$, the Bose factor gives $-1/8$, and the angular measure gives $-\lambda^2 dr/(16\pi^2 r)$. A cutoff rescaling therefore produces $+\lambda^2 \log c/(16\pi^2)$; the outgoing-projector ratio $2!/3! = 1/3$ fixes $+1/48$ per unordered pair and $+1/16$ over three pairs. Projector idempotence supplies the opposite hard block $-1/16$, or $-3/512$ after multiplication by the Born coefficient.

This normalization is not yet the physical neutral answer. With the published fixed-vacuum charges $q(\Omega) = +1$, $q(\Upsilon) = -1$ and the BT dagger preserving charge, the two logarithmic contractions have generator charges $(+1, -1)$ and $(-1, +1)$, each with residue $-1/4$. Consequently no logarithmic row lies wholly in the one-sided nonpositive image; imposing that projection before the Gram makes the residue exactly zero. A completed broken-vacuum pushforward might instead use background shifts of both signs to place the pair in its neutral component, but neither the required zero-mode operator nor $R_t P_2 R_t^\dagger$ is available in the Letter. Thus the exact alternatives are: the neutralized $1/48$, zero after one-sided projection, or positive-charge leakage outside the present radical argument. This exact `LOCAL-ALGEBRAIC, REDUCED-MODE` classification is recorded by `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_SOFT_CHARGE_RESOLVED_FLOW.V1`, downstream of `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_FULL_OFF_RESONANT_PROJECTOR.V1`. Its finite-cutoff formal flow $K_t = e^{-idt} D - e^{idt} D^\sharp$ is anti-Krein and has $H_{\text{as}}^{(1)} = d(e^{-idt} D + e^{idt} D^\sharp)$; sharp and smooth cutoffs have the same leading logarithmic response but retain a finite matching constant. It neither establishes the physical neutral coefficient nor a complete probability.

The global broken-vacuum orbit admits an exact operator realization without a c-number spurion. Set $\phi = \phi_0 + \varphi$ and $Z = e^{\lambda\phi_0}$. Then Eq. (16) factorizes as $\Omega = Z\hat{\Omega}$ and $\Upsilon = Z^{-1}\hat{\Upsilon}$ on $\mathbb{Q}[Z, Z^{-1}]$, with $\delta Z^n = nZ^n$. Covariance uniquely dresses a quadratic coefficient by $Z^{q_p - q_{d_1} - q_{d_2}}$. All eight number-lowering rows are consequently neutral, and the two logarithmic orbit powers cancel in their Gram, preserving the conditional 1/48 response. However, the repaired Appendix-C pullback implies $A_1 = Zb_\Upsilon$; its squeeze is therefore $Z^2(b_\Upsilon^\dagger)^2$, of total charge zero rather than -2 . Conversely the fixed-vacuum ideal $I = (Z - 1)$ is not stable under the charge derivation, since $\delta(Z - 1) = Z \equiv 1 \pmod{I}$. Thus fixed-vacuum negative grading and covariant zero-mode completion do not commute. The certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_ZERO_MODE_EQ19_TRILEMMA_V1` records this exact obstruction. It does not replace the missing full dynamical zero-mode module, invariant generalized-Born trace, or nonlinear pushforward, and therefore does not prove Eq. (19), the physical 1/48, or its negation.

There is also a topology obstruction before that missing trace can be used on the ordinary Fock carrier. The certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_SQUEEZED_VACUUM_IMPLEMENTABILITY_V1` normalizes the Appendix-C creation generator in a periodic box and classifies the compatible charge-exchanging fundamental symmetries. If the positive metric weights the Υ direction by $\rho(\mathbf{p})$, uniform equivalence requires $0 < m \leq \rho \leq M$. Direct Wick contraction then gives

$$\frac{1}{V} \|Q_+|0\rangle\|_\kappa^2 = \frac{\rho^2}{64\pi^2} (\epsilon^{-1} - \Lambda^{-1})$$

for constant ρ , and the six lowest box modes give a lower-bound density $3m^2L/(256\pi^4)$. The pair-creation block has twice this divergent norm. The squeeze is therefore Krein-null but not a vector, nor ordinarily Bogoliubov-implementable, in the massless positive Fock topology. A weight $\rho(p) \sim p^\alpha$ could soften the integral only for $\alpha > 1/2$, when ρ^{-1} is unbounded and the topology is inequivalent. This exact `LOCAL-ALGEBRAIC_REDUCED-MODE` obstruction neither refutes the algebraic map nor excludes a rigorously defined extended/non-Fock representation of Eq. (19).

The full exponential sharpens this carrier test. For an unordered momentum pair its exact normalized amplitude is $z(p) = \rho(p)/(4p^2)$, so a vector requires both $\sup_p |z(p)| < 1$ and square summability. Any uniformly equivalent $\rho \geq m > 0$ violates the first condition once $L \geq 4\pi/\sqrt{m}$. An explicit inequivalent repair is

$$\rho_\mu(p) = \frac{4\gamma\mu^2 p^2}{p^2 + \mu^2}, \quad z_\mu(p) = \frac{\gamma\mu^2}{p^2 + \mu^2}, \quad 0 < \gamma < 1,$$

whose unordered square-sum density is $\gamma^2\mu^3/(16\pi)$. Its inverse metric is unbounded at the origin and its thermodynamic vacuum leaves the ordinary Fock sector. Moreover, the raw BT shear has positive-Hilbert coefficients $u = 1, v = z$ and hence $u^2 - v^2 = 1 - z^2 \neq 1$: it is cross-Krein canonical, not a positive-Hilbert Bogoliubov transformation. Generic extended positive-boson implementation theorems therefore do not apply verbatim and do not provide the missing cyclic BT trace. The certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_EXTENDED_SQUEEZE_CARRIER_V1` records this constructive but inequivalent vacuum carrier and the remaining trace obstruction.

The cross-Krein construction can nevertheless be completed at finite regulator. Complete the orbit on $\ell^2(\mathbb{Z})$ with $[e_m, e_n] = \delta_{m+n,0}$ and $J_0 e_n = e_{-n}$. Then Z is the bilateral shift and

$Z^\dagger = Z$. On the weighted oscillator carrier,

$$Q = \sum_{\{p, -p\}} (z_p Z^2 A_p^* A_{-p}^* - \bar{z}_p Z^2 D_p D_{-p})$$

obeys $Q^\dagger = -Q$ and defines a densely defined closable squeeze on paired polynomial/Gaussian cores. The finite-rank trace $\text{Tr}_{\text{fin}} \Theta_{x,y} = [y, x]$ is cyclic and invariant under this transport.

This finite construction has an exact extension obstruction. For $E_n = Z^n E_0 Z^{-n}$, cyclicity gives $\tau(E_n) = c$. If $\tau(1) = 1$ and τ is positive on the J_0 -even projection cone, then $P_N = \sum_{n=-N}^N E_n$ gives $(2N+1)c \leq 1$ for every N , hence $c = 0$. The finite-rank trace instead has $\text{Tr}_{\text{fin}}(E_0) = 1$ but infinite identity weight. There is also no normal trace-norm limit: for the explicit weight above,

$$\frac{1}{V} \log \|P_V\|_1 \longrightarrow \ell(\gamma, \mu) = \frac{\mu^3}{12\pi} \left[(1+\gamma)^{3/2} + (1-\gamma)^{3/2} - 2 \right] > 0.$$

The certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_CROSS_KREIN_TRACE_LIMIT_V1` therefore isolates the open problem as an explicit semifinite, relative, or non-normal Born weight and the full nonlinear Eq. (19) transport. It does not establish the physical $1/48$.

The semifinite branch has an exact finite-detector realization. On $B(\ell^2(\mathbb{Z}))$, the canonical faithful normal semifinite trace satisfies $\text{Tr}_\infty(E_n) = 1$ and $\text{Tr}_\infty(1) = +\infty$. Let P_{in} be a finite-rank J -even Krein projection, let S be cross-Krein isometric on its range, and let P_i be a finite exhaustive output partition there. If every $A_i = P_i S P_{\text{in}} = B_i + C_i$ has the weak ghost decomposition, then

$$p_i = \frac{\text{Tr}_{\text{fin}}(A_i^\dagger A_i)}{\text{Tr}_{\text{fin}}(P_{\text{in}})} \geq 0, \quad \sum_i p_i = 1.$$

The proof uses weak-ghost trace orthogonality for positivity and $S^\dagger S = 1$ for normalization; it never uses a finite trace of the identity. This does not contradict the preceding no-go because the normalized corner functional is not cyclic. The exact matrix-unit witness $P = E_{00}$, $X = E_{01}$, $Y = E_{10}$ gives $\omega_P(XY) = 1$ and $\omega_P(YX) = 0$. The certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_SEMIFINITE_RELATIVE_BORN_WEIGHT_V1` records the construction with dependency tags `LOCAL-ALGEBRAIC` and `REDUCED-MODE`. It does not prove that the unbounded squeeze preserves the required trace ideal, construct a non-normal thermodynamic state, reproduce Eq. (19), or establish the physical $1/48$.

The available zero-mode-completed logarithmic detector sector admits a sharper domain test. For N orthogonal logarithmic cells, the conditional amplitude $a = \sqrt{3}/12$ defines the skew finite-carrier generator $Kh = a \sum_i d_i$, $Kd_i = -ah$. The transported rank-one projection has

$$P_1 = a \sum_i (|d_i\rangle\langle h| + |h\rangle\langle d_i|), \quad P_2 = a^2 \sum_{i,j} |d_i\rangle\langle d_j| - Na^2 |h\rangle\langle h|,$$

and satisfies projector idempotence through order λ^2 . The unique orbit dressing makes this certified sector neutral, with no strictly negative radical. Each finite- N coefficient remains finite rank on the weighted squeeze core. Nevertheless,

$$\text{Tr } P_1 = \text{Tr } P_2 = 0, \quad \|P_1\|_1^2 = \frac{N}{12}, \quad \|P_2\|_1 = \frac{N}{24}.$$

The signed hard/soft box trace $-N/48 + N/48$ cancels while its absolute trace weight grows. Hence the finite detector lies in the semifinite paired ideal, but the logarithmic soft-cutoff limit is not uniformly trace class in this sector. This exact distinction is recorded by `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_FINITE_DETECTOR_PUSHFORWARD_V1`. It leaves open an operator-level cancellation from omitted pushforward sectors, a hard matching construction, or a local non-normal renormalized weight, and does not prove Eq. (19) or the physical $1/48$.

The complete signed quadratic composition supplies that operator-level cancellation at order λ . A target $b_{\Upsilon}(s, p)$ has, at leading order, the three inverse images $a_1(s, p)$, the secular part of $a_2(s, p)$, and the oscillatory part of $a_2(-s, -p)$. Symplectic extraction multiplies the last image by the inverse of its Appendix-C oscillatory phase. Summing all sign sectors gives

$$\begin{aligned}\delta b_{\Omega} &= \frac{s_1 e_1 + s_2 e_2}{2e_1 e_2} b_{\Omega}^{(s_1)} b_{\Omega}^{(s_2)}, \\ \delta b_{\Upsilon} &= -\frac{s_2}{2e_1} b_{\Omega}^{(s_1)} b_{\Upsilon}^{(s_2)} - \frac{s_1}{2e_2} b_{\Upsilon}^{(s_1)} b_{\Omega}^{(s_2)},\end{aligned}$$

with every other row zero. The daughter Krein contraction has $G_{\Omega\Upsilon} = G_{\Upsilon\Omega} = 0$; because the parent inverse metric is off diagonal, the quadratic parent trace has no dr/r term. The mixed-sign rows close the order- λ cross-CCR Ward identity, and the unique Z dressing makes the associated finite-mode cubic generator neutral. Thus $R_t P_0 R_t^\dagger = P_0 + \lambda[K, P_0] + O(\lambda^2)$ has the Eq. (19) decomposition with $Q_1 = 0$ on the finite-mode quadratic carrier. The certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_FULL_SIGNED_QUADRATIC_CLOSURE_V1` records 128 exact preimage contributions and 48 exact Ward fixtures with dependency tags `LOCAL-ALGEBRAIC` and `REDUCED-MODE`. The logarithmic normalization is a conditional theorem for the resonant truncation; it does not survive the complete public quadratic map. No physical coefficient follows from this projector-pushforward kernel: the S-matrix transition block is a distinct object. The squeezed-vacuum and dynamical-zero-mode projector trace, continuum domain, and higher composite orders remain open within Eq. (19). The Appendix-C squeeze does not supply another additive coefficient on this finite paired core. Writing the finite-regulator map as $R(\lambda) = S(1 + \lambda K + O(\lambda^2))$, cross-Krein isometry gives

$$(SKS^{-1})^\dagger (SKS^{-1}) = S(K^\dagger K)S^{-1}.$$

Transporting the detector by the same similarity and using the finite-rank cyclic trace leaves the completed quadratic coefficient at zero. The exact $3/16$ bare one-pair occupation of the normalized $z = 1/2$ squeezed vacuum holds a b -Fock detector fixed and is not an Eq. (19) pushforward probability. This distinction is certified by `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_SQUEEZED_DETECTOR_SIMILARITY_V1`. Its `LOCAL-ALGEBRAIC`, `REDUCED-MODE` zero is a finite-regulator pushforward result. The non-trace-class thermodynamic limit, dynamical zero mode, and higher orders remain open for Eq. (19), and the distinct S-matrix kernel must be evaluated for a physical response. The finite paired-process algebra does admit a thermodynamic conditional functional without trace-norm convergence. Tensoring by squeezed spectator projections of Krein trace one leaves all local weak-ghost Born weights unchanged; an exact fixture gives $9/25, 16/25, 0$ at every spectator volume while the positive trace norm grows as $(4/3)^N$. Hence the pointwise zero quadratic coefficient has a regulator-independent cylinder limit. Certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_CYLINDER_BORN_LIMIT_V1` does not identify this pair-cylinder algebra with an inclusive LSZ or spacetime-local detector. The orthogonal-block lemma does not identify its input kernel. The complete signed kernel above is the

$R_t P R_t^\dagger$ projector pushforward, whereas the physical real process is $P_{\text{out}}(S-1)P_{\text{in}}$. Certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_INCLUSIVE_NLO_OBJECT_LEDGER_V1` keeps the exact zero pushforward trace but assigns the five-point process its independently computed response: $+1/512$ per pair, $+3/512$ in total, and $1/48$ per pair after Born normalization. The axis-compatible physical virtual response vanishes, leaving $+3/512$ uncanceled. The public R_t response also vanishes but is a distinct Eq. (19) object, not a physical summand; an independently normalized hard/dressed term $-3/512$ is missing. The complete NLO probability and all-order Eq. (19) remain open. The missing coefficient is nevertheless universal under a correctly typed physical-shell pseudo-unitarity assumption. For $S_{\text{phys}}(x) = 1 + xA + x^2B + O(x^3)$,

$$A^\dagger = -A, \quad B + B^\dagger + A^\dagger A = 0.$$

The certified real column gives $\|Ah\|^2 = 1/16$, so $\text{Re } B_{hh} = -1/32$ and the hard survival response is $-1/16$, or $-3/512$ after multiplication by the Born coefficient. Certificate `REVERSE_PHYSICS_BT_PHYSICAL_PSEUDOUNITARY_COMPLETION_V1` supplies an exact finite $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})$ isometric witness and proves independence from phases and anti-Hermitian second-order freedom. It does not construct the continuum dressed S-matrix, its degenerate trace domain, or beyond-tree positivity.

Remark 14.5 (Physical ultraviolet hard-scattering law). The Born rate, perfect-square beta function, and projected virtual hard log are

$$\frac{d\sigma_{\text{Born}}}{d\Omega} = \frac{3\lambda^4}{32\pi^2 s}, \quad \beta_\lambda = -\frac{5\lambda^3}{16\pi^2}, \quad \frac{d\sigma_{\text{virt,log}}}{d\Omega} = \frac{5\lambda^6}{256\pi^4 s} (L_s + L_t + L_u).$$

At fixed nonforward angle, all three channel invariants scale with s . The exact scale-derivative identity is therefore

$$-4 \left(\frac{5}{16} \right) \left(\frac{3}{32} \right) + 2 \cdot 3 \left(\frac{5}{256} \right) = 0.$$

Thus the explicitly computed hard logarithm supplies precisely the coefficient required by the independently computed running of the Born rate. With

$$D(s) = \lambda_0^{-2} + \frac{5}{16\pi^2} \log \frac{s}{s_0}, \quad \lambda_0 = \lambda(\sqrt{s_0}),$$

the leading ultraviolet logarithms resum to

$$\frac{d\sigma_{\text{hard}}^{\text{LL}}}{d\Omega} = \frac{3}{32\pi^2 s D(s)^2} = \frac{24\pi^2}{25s \log^2(s/\Lambda^2)}, \quad \Lambda^2 = s_0 e^{-16\pi^2/(5\lambda_0^2)}.$$

For a fixed detector acceptance $\theta_0 \leq \theta \leq \pi - \theta_0$, $0 < \theta_0 < \pi/2$, this gives

$$\lim_{s \rightarrow \infty} s \log^2(s/\Lambda^2) \sigma_{\text{window}}^{\text{LL}} = \frac{96\pi^3}{25} \cos \theta_0.$$

The result is positive on the asymptotically-free UV branch, and its leading $1/\log^2 s$ coefficient is invariant under analytic coupling-scheme changes. It is the physical short-distance baseline for a nonforward acceptance, not an infrared-complete exclusive particle-number probability. Real-virtual endpoint cancellation, the Jordan/ R_t dressing, incoming degenerate sectors, and next-to-leading-log finite terms remain unconstructed.

Where the double pole goes. One structural remark, since it bears on which route is the likelier to extend. The obstruction that withdraws the cutting rules at coincident poles is that the cut weight there is a derivative of a delta rather than a measure of definite sign. That is a property of the fourth-order *variable* and not of the theory: in the two-field frame of [4] the same dynamics is carried by two second-order fields whose propagator is off-diagonal, so every pole is simple and every cut an ordinary delta. The double pole is removed by the change of variables rather than by any additional hypothesis. That is a plausible reason why the Krein route reaches tree level at the locus where the positive route stops, and it suggests the positive-metric programme could be continued past its own Sec. VI in those variables rather than in the fourth-order field.

Open questions. Whether the two pointed sectors admit parity vacua $(|0_A\rangle \pm |0_B\rangle)/\sqrt{2}$ or are superselected requires finite-volume overlap and zero-mode analysis — in the hyperbolic polar coordinates $r = UV$, $\chi = \frac{1}{2} \log(U/V)$ (a coordinate presentation of the $O(1,1)$ model: boost = χ -shift, exchange = $\chi \mapsto -\chi$, conserved current $j = V\partial U - U\partial V = 2r\partial\chi$) this becomes a boundary/self-adjoint-extension problem at the null locus $r = 0$, where the conserved charge produces a singular q^2/r barrier. The quantum implementation of the exchange on a completion, and any probability interpretation beyond [4], remain open; so does a normal-ordered operator Ward identity for the internal charge (the classical identity, with its exact regulator breaking $\epsilon u(1+u) - \mu^2 v$, is verified). The hierarchy conjecture’s 5:1 prediction is confirmed at fourth order (Proposition 7.4), and its 5:3 and 7:1 instances are confirmed at sixth order (Proposition 7.5); higher coprime loci and the mechanism excluding even mode-2 transfers remain open. The ordinary scalar independent-mass route is obstructed: Remark 14.3 supplies its collinear logarithmic obstruction. Remark 14.4 shows that coherent projector transport passes the finite coefficient and charge preflights. A complete construction must derive the splitting generator from the broken-vacuum BT/PS asymptotic Hamiltonian, construct the continuum and incoming degenerate sectors, and only then evaluate the quotient trace. The gravitational extension is established at tree level in the sequel: the exact Einstein–Weyl cubic and quartic vertices, physical helicities, and Ward/BRST checks produce a second-order metric obstruction. That result does not import the scalar infrared proposition; any Bateman–Turok-type gravitational completion would need its own parent/daughter and asymptotic-state construction. No CPT claim is made: the exchange is a linear sector map, not a constructed antiunitary CPT operator.

References

- [1] C. M. Bender and P. D. Mannheim, *No-ghost theorem for the fourth-order derivative Pais–Uhlenbeck oscillator model*, Phys. Rev. Lett. **100** (2008) 110402, doi:10.1103/physrevlett.100.110402.
- [2] C. M. Bender and P. D. Mannheim, *Exactly solvable PT-symmetric Hamiltonian having no Hermitian counterpart*, Phys. Rev. D **78** (2008) 025022, arXiv:0804.4190.
- [3] P. D. Mannheim, *Unitarity of loop diagrams for the ghost-like $1/(k^2 - M_1^2) - 1/(k^2 - M_2^2)$ propagator*, Phys. Rev. D **98** (2018) 045014, arXiv:1801.03220.

- [4] S. Bateman and N. Turok, *Escape from Ostrogradsky via hidden ghost parity*, arXiv:2607.00096.
- [5] A. Mostafazadeh, *Metric operator in pseudo-Hermitian quantum mechanics and the imaginary cubic potential*, J. Phys. A **39** (2006) 10171, arXiv:quant-ph/0508195.
- [6] A. Mostafazadeh, *Pseudo-Hermiticity for a class of nondiagonalizable Hamiltonians*, J. Math. Phys. **43** (2002) 6343, arXiv:math-ph/0207009.
- [7] J. Feinberg and M. Znojil, *Which metrics are consistent with a given pseudo-Hermitian matrix?*, arXiv:2111.04216.
- [8] P. D. Mannheim, *CPT symmetry without Hermiticity*, arXiv:1611.02100.
- [9] J. Liu, L. Modesto and G. Calcagni, *Quantum field theory with ghost pairs*, arXiv:2208.13536.
- [10] T. Ya. Azizov and I. S. Iokhvidov, *Linear Operators in Spaces with an Indefinite Metric*, Wiley, 1989.
- [11] GPT-5.6.sol and A. A. Palm, *Canonical Positive Symplectic Diagonalization of the Pais–Uhlenbeck Oscillator*, Paper I of the pure-Weyl gravity programme, 2026; file `paper/01-symplectic-diagonalization.pdf` in the repository <https://github.com/area9innovation/weyl-gravity>.
- [12] GPT-5.6.sol and A. A. Palm, *The Pais–Uhlenbeck Metric as a Minimum-Distortion Principle, and the Representation Problem for the Fourth-Order Field*, Paper II of the pure-Weyl gravity programme, 2026; file `paper/02-variational-fock.pdf` in the repository <https://github.com/area9innovation/weyl-gravity>.
- [13] GPT-5.6.sol and A. A. Palm, *The Universal Vacuum of the Fourth-Order Scalar Field: Metric Orbits, Fock Sectors, and the Krein Boundary*, Paper III of the pure-Weyl gravity programme, 2026; file `paper/03-fourth-order-vacuum.pdf` in the repository <https://github.com/area9innovation/weyl-gravity>.
- [14] GPT-5.6.sol and A. A. Palm, *Gauge Reduction and the Completion Problem in Fourth-Order Gravity: PU Pairing, Covariant Real Forms, and the Conformal Jordan Boundary*, Paper IV of the pure-Weyl gravity programme, 2026; file `paper/04-fourth-order-gravity.pdf` in the repository <https://github.com/area9innovation/weyl-gravity>.
- [15] T. Kato, *Perturbation Theory for Linear Operators*, Springer, 1966.
- [16] W. D. Heiss, *The physics of exceptional points*, J. Phys. A **45** (2012) 444016, doi:10.1088/1751-8113/45/44/444016.

A The Weyl–Moyal recursion

Operators are represented by Weyl symbols on the two canonical pairs (x, p) , (y, q) ; the star product is $f \star g = \sum_n \frac{1}{n!} (i/2)^n \Lambda^n(f, g)$ with $\Lambda = \overleftarrow{\partial}_x \overrightarrow{\partial}_p - \overleftarrow{\partial}_p \overrightarrow{\partial}_x + \overleftarrow{\partial}_y \overrightarrow{\partial}_q - \overleftarrow{\partial}_q \overrightarrow{\partial}_y$, a finite

sum on polynomials. For quadratic h_0 , $[h_0, \mathcal{W}[f]] = i\mathcal{W}[\{h_0, f\}]$ exactly; for cubic–cubic commutators the Λ^3 (constant) term contributes. Expanding $h_\zeta = e^{-X/2} \star (h_0 + \zeta v) \star e^{X/2}$, $X = \zeta R_1 + \zeta^2 R_2 + \zeta^3 R_3$, with $e^{-X/2} A e^{X/2} = A + \frac{1}{2}[A, X] + \frac{1}{8}[[A, X], X] + \frac{1}{48}[[[A, X], X], X] + \dots$, the order- ζ^2 and ζ^3 Hermiticity conditions are

$$[h_0, R_2] = (v_2^\dagger - v_2) + \frac{1}{2}[R_1, v + v^\dagger], \quad (23)$$

$$[h_0, R_3] = -(T_3 - T_3^\dagger), \quad (24)$$

$$T_3 = \frac{1}{8}([h_0, R_1], R_2] + [[h_0, R_2], R_1]) + \frac{1}{48}[[[h_0, R_1], R_1], R_1] + \frac{1}{2}[v, R_2] + \frac{1}{8}[[v, R_1], R_1],$$

using $[h_0, R_1] = v^\dagger - v$ and the fact that $[v - v^\dagger, R_1]$ is Hermitian. Equations $[h_0, R] = S$ are solved monomial by monomial in the mode variables $a_1^m a_1^{\dagger n} a_2^r a_2^{\dagger s}$, where $[h_0, M] = \Omega_M M$ with $\Omega_M = (n - m)\omega_1 + (s - r)\omega_2$: $R_M = S_M/\Omega_M$ off the kernel; the kernel component is the obstruction.

B The 3:1 projection and gauge independence

At $\omega_1 = 3\omega_2$ the second-order source $S_2 = \frac{1}{2}[R_1, v + v^\dagger]$ is a quartic polynomial; its kernel monomials must satisfy $(n - m)3\omega_2 + (s - r)\omega_2 = 0$ with degree ≤ 4 , i.e. $(m - n, r - s) = \pm(1, -3)$, realized only by $a_1 a_2^{\dagger 3}$ and $a_1^\dagger a_2^3$. Direct evaluation of the two coefficients gives $\mathfrak{o}_+^{(2)} = \frac{27\sqrt{3}}{320\omega_2^4}(a_1 a_2^{\dagger 3} - a_1^\dagger a_2^3)$. Gauge independence: a change $R_1 \rightarrow R_1 + G$ with $[G, h_0] = 0$ shifts S_2 by $\frac{1}{2}[G, v + v^\dagger]$; transfer bookkeeping shows that for every Hermitian kernel generator (N_1, N_2 polynomials and the resonant quartics $a_1 a_2^{\dagger 3} + a_1^\dagger a_2^3, i(a_1 a_2^{\dagger 3} - a_1^\dagger a_2^3)$) the shifted source has no kernel component: the transfers of $v + v^\dagger$, shifted by $\pm(1, -3)$ or $(0, 0)$, never land on $\pm(1, -3)$; machine verification confirms $\Pi_{\ker \text{ad}_{h_0}}[G, v + v^\dagger] = 0$ term by term. Anti-Hermitian generators A_1 enter through $\frac{1}{2}[v - v^\dagger, A_1]$, and the same bookkeeping gives $\Pi_{\ker \text{ad}_{h_0}}[v - v^\dagger, A_1] = 0$. Kernel additions to R_2 drop out of the second-order equation since $[h_0, R_2^{\ker}] = 0$.

C The effective shell matrix

Standard second-order degenerate perturbation theory on the shell $\mathcal{E}_{27} = \text{span}\{|j, 27 - 3j\rangle\}$ gives $K_{ab}^{(2)} = \sum_{m \notin \mathcal{E}} v_{am} v_{mb} / (27 - E_m)$ (the first-order block vanishes: cubic v cannot realize the transfer $\pm(1, -3)$). Evaluating the sums yields the rational diagonal $D(n_1, n_2) = (633n_1^2 - 1836n_1 n_2 - 285n_1 + 3969n_2^2 + 3051n_2 + 818)/26880$ and the antisymmetric off-diagonal quoted in Theorem 6.2. For a tridiagonal matrix only the products $K_{j,j+1} K_{j+1,j} \in \mathbb{Q}$ enter the characteristic polynomial, computed exactly by the three-term recurrence $p_j = (D_j - \kappa)p_{j-1} - K_{j-1,j} K_{j,j-1} p_{j-2}$; the Sturm count of the resulting degree-10 rational polynomial is exactly 8.

D The transfer lattice

Transfer additivity: the grading by ad_{h_0} satisfies $[h_0, AB] = [h_0, A]B + A[h_0, B]$, so transfers add under operator products, hence under star products and commutators. Degree bound: each commutator of polynomial factors lowers total degree by at least two (Λ^1), so order- n objects, built from n cubic factors and $n - 1$ commutators (with $[h_0, \cdot]$ degree-preserving), have degree $\leq 3n - 2(n - 1) = n + 2$; Moyal corrections lower degree by even amounts, fixing

the parity $\equiv n \bmod 2$. A kernel monomial with transfer (d_1, d_2) , $d_1 d_2 < 0$, requires degree $\geq |d_1| + |d_2|$ with matching per-mode parities, giving the candidate sets of Theorem 7.1.

E Field conventions, the source formula, and truncation completeness

Conventions. Finite volume; discrete momenta k (lattice units with $m_L = 4$ in Theorem 12.1); modes (b, k) with $[a_{b,k}, a_{b',k'}^\dagger] = \delta_{bb'} \delta_{kk'}$; unit-norm external states; $g = 1$; deformation parameter ζ multiplying H_3 , ζ^2 multiplying H_4 . Positive-frame legs from the branch eigenvectors: u -legs $(a_+ + a_+^\dagger)/\sqrt{2\omega_+ \delta}$ (healthy) and $(a_- - a_-^\dagger)/\sqrt{2\omega_- \delta}$ (ghost, quarter-turn); v -legs $\rho_\pm$ times u -legs, $\rho_\pm = \mp \delta/(2g)$. Interactions $H_3 = -g \int uv^2$, $H_4 = -\frac{g}{2} \int u^2 v^2$ are pure potentials. The transported fourth-order field of Section 10 is fixed by matching the free two-point function $[e^{-i\omega_1 t}/2\omega_1 - e^{-i\omega_2 t}/2\omega_2]/\delta$ of [13]; the even-ghost rule follows because a monomial with g ghost legs, c_g of them creators, has v -coefficient $\propto i^{\# \text{legs}} (-1)^{c_g}$ and $v^\dagger$ -coefficient $\propto$ the conjugate with $c_g \rightarrow g - c_g$, whose difference vanishes for odd g .

Source formula. With $E_{\text{in}} = E_{\text{out}} = E$ and R_1 solved off shell, $\langle \text{out} | [R_1, w] | \text{in} \rangle = \sum_n [(v^\dagger - v)_{\text{out},n} w_{n,\text{in}} + w_{\text{out},n} (v^\dagger - v)_{n,\text{in}}] / (E - E_n)$ with $w = v + v^\dagger$; the algebraic identity $(v^\dagger - v)w + w(v^\dagger - v) = 2(v^\dagger v^\dagger - vv)$ reduces this to (15).

Truncation completeness (proof of Lemma 12.2). Second-order chains pass through 1-, 3-, or 5-particle intermediates. 1-particle: momentum $k_a + k_b$ fixed. 3-particle: the first vertex annihilates one external and creates a pair $(q, k_x - q)$; for the second vertex to reach the 2-particle out-state, the surviving created particle must be an out-particle, forcing $q \in \{k_c, k_d, k_x - k_c, k_x - k_d\}$; annihilating both created particles instead returns the in-momenta, giving zero overlap with a distinct out-state. 5-particle: the created triple (p, q, r) , $p + q + r = 0$, must contain both out-particles, fixing the third momentum. Hence all internal momenta lie in the s, t, u -generated set, and enlarging the momentum cutoff cannot change the element — as the exact agreement at $K_{\text{max}} = 4, 6$ confirms.

F The doubled confluent parity

With change-of-basis matrix C whose columns are (c, d) in branch coordinates, $P_\delta^{(c,d)} = C^{-1} \text{diag}(1, -1) C = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 2/\delta \\ \delta/2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$. For the doubled space take $C_A = C$ and the oppositely oriented C_B (columns $c_B = (b_+ - b_-)/2$, $d_B = (b_+ + b_-)/\delta$); the cross map $\kappa(b_\pm^A) = \pm b_\pm^B$ has matrix $T^{-1} \kappa_{\text{branch}} T$ with $T = \text{diag}(C_A, C_B)$, which evaluates to the δ -independent exchange $(c_A, d_A) \leftrightarrow (c_B, d_B)$, squaring to the identity.

G Verification checks and their classification

Check	Supports	Type
ID1–ID5	Theorem 3.1	exact symbolic
ID6–ID8	Theorem 4.1	exact symbolic
ID9a–b	Theorem 5.1	exact symbolic
ID10, O3e	Comp. Prop. 8.2	high-precision numeric
SR1–SR3	Theorem 7.1	exact combinatorial
O3a–O3d	Theorem 7.2	exact symbolic
PT1–PT2	Theorem 6.2 (structure)	exact symbolic
Sturm count	Theorem 6.2 (pair)	exact rational
PT3	Theorem 6.2 (truncated op.)	numeric
PT4	broken-PT tongues	numeric (effective matrix)
PS1–PS2	Proposition 9.1	exact symbolic
PS-A–PS-G	Theorem 10.1, Comp. Prop.	exact symbolic + numeric
PS-H	Jordan-chain lemma	exact symbolic
TF1–TF7	Theorem 11.1, Prop. 11.2	exact symbolic
SO1–SO7	Theorem 12.1 (numerics)	exact + numeric
HX1	Theorem 12.1 (exact value)	exact symbolic
HX2–HX3	Theorem 13.1	exact symbolic
PT proposition	Proposition 6.1	exact symbolic
$\omega_2^{-13/2}$ ratio	Theorem 7.2	exact symbolic
R_1 Laurent	Theorem 8.1	exact symbolic
DQ1–DQ2, DQ9	$O(1,1)$ polar form, current, Ward	exact symbolic
DQ3–DQ6	doubled pairing, graph, pseudo-unitarity	numeric
DQ7–DQ8	Comp. Prop. 12.4	exact symbolic
FO1–FO9	Comp. Prop. 7.4, Conj. 7.3	exact symbolic
ON1–ON4	Lemma 14.1, Comp. Prop. 14.2	exact symbolic + numeric
BT-RV	Remark 14.3	exact symbolic/rational
BT-AG	Remark 14.4	exact rational/algebraic
BT-UV	Remark 14.5	exact rational/RG consistency

Scripts, in symbolic/, each printing ALL PASS:

```
verify_interaction_deformation.py verify_interaction_order3.py
verify_pt_breaking.py verify_perfect_square.py verify_two_field.py
verify_sector_obstruction.py verify_hardening.py
verify_doubled_theory.py verify_51_order4.py
verify_obstruction_null.py
```

The scalar real–virtual extension is reproduced independently from the repository root by

```
ulimit -v 500000; python3 \
reverse_physics/bt_real_virtual_axis_gluing.py --check
ulimit -v 500000; python3 \
reverse_physics/verify_bt_real_virtual_axis_gluing.py
ulimit -v 500000; python3 -m unittest -v \
reverse_physics.tests.test_bt_real_virtual_axis_gluing
```

The corrected finite-projector and asymptotic-generator preflight is reproduced by

```
ulimit -v 500000; python3 \
reverse_physics/bt_asymptotic_generator_preflight.py --check
```



```
ulimit -v 500000; python3 \
reverse_physics/verify_bt_asymptotic_generator_preflight.py
ulimit -v 500000; python3 -m unittest -v \
reverse_physics.tests.test_bt_asymptotic_generator_preflight
```

The dynamically derived order- λ R_t kernel, Appendix C label consistency test, secular cancellation, and endpoint Gram are reproduced by

```
ulimit -v 500000; python3 \
reverse_physics/bt_rt_jordan_kernel.py --check
ulimit -v 500000; python3 \
reverse_physics/verify_bt_rt_jordan_kernel.py
ulimit -v 500000; python3 -m unittest -v \
reverse_physics.tests.test_bt_rt_jordan_kernel
```

The physical ultraviolet hard/window law is reproduced by

```
ulimit -v 500000; python3 \
reverse_physics/bt_uv_hard_scattering_law.py --check
ulimit -v 500000; python3 \
reverse_physics/verify_bt_uv_hard_scattering_law.py
ulimit -v 500000; python3 -m unittest -v \
reverse_physics.tests.test_bt_uv_hard_scattering_law
```